Functional Area #6: Structure of the HR Function

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HR's Strategic Role in the Organization



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HR's Administrative and Operational Roles

Administrative

- Use technology to capture and analyze data, reduce transactional time
- Focus on core capabilities

Operational

- Knowledge management
- Talent acquisition and development
- Incentive systems
- Employee engagement programs

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Developing an HR Service Culture

All aspects of the HR function must be examined:

- ✓ Strategy, how HR will create value for the organization
- ✓ Shared values, how a commitment to service is communicated
- ✓ Structure, how HR can be more efficient and innovative
- ✓ Systems, what tools are needed
- ✓ Staff, what performance will be rewarded
- ✓ Skills, what capabilities are needed to deliver service
- ✓ Style of leadership, how leaders model customer service values

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Core Business Functions



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Executive Management

The C-suite is ultimately responsible for all of the core business functions and their effect on the organization's performance.

- Develop and communicate strategy.
- Monitor and control implementation of strategic and operational activities through control of financial resources.
- Be the primary interface with the organization's stakeholders.
- Lead the organization through a shared vision and the values they model.

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Finance and Accounting

Finance:

- Supports operations and strategic initiatives through the creation and monitoring of operating and capital expenditure budgets.
- Provides financial analysis used in strategic planning.
- Manages the organization's "treasury."

Accounting:

- Focuses on tracking financial transactions and reporting financial information to finance and to external stakeholders.

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Marketing and Sales

Brings in revenue; may be separate functions or together.

Marketing Strategies

Often categorized as:

- "Push"—getting products/ services in front of customers.
- "Pull"—attracting customers to the product.

Sales Strategies

- Heavily influenced by an industry's customary distribution practices and the company's marketing strategy.
- Affects HR needs, including talent acquisition and compensation.

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Research and Development (R&D)

- Generates future revenue through new product design and development.
- May be conducted in a centralized manner (for example, with a globalized strategy) or implemented in business units so that projects stay focused on customer needs.



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Operations and IT

Operations

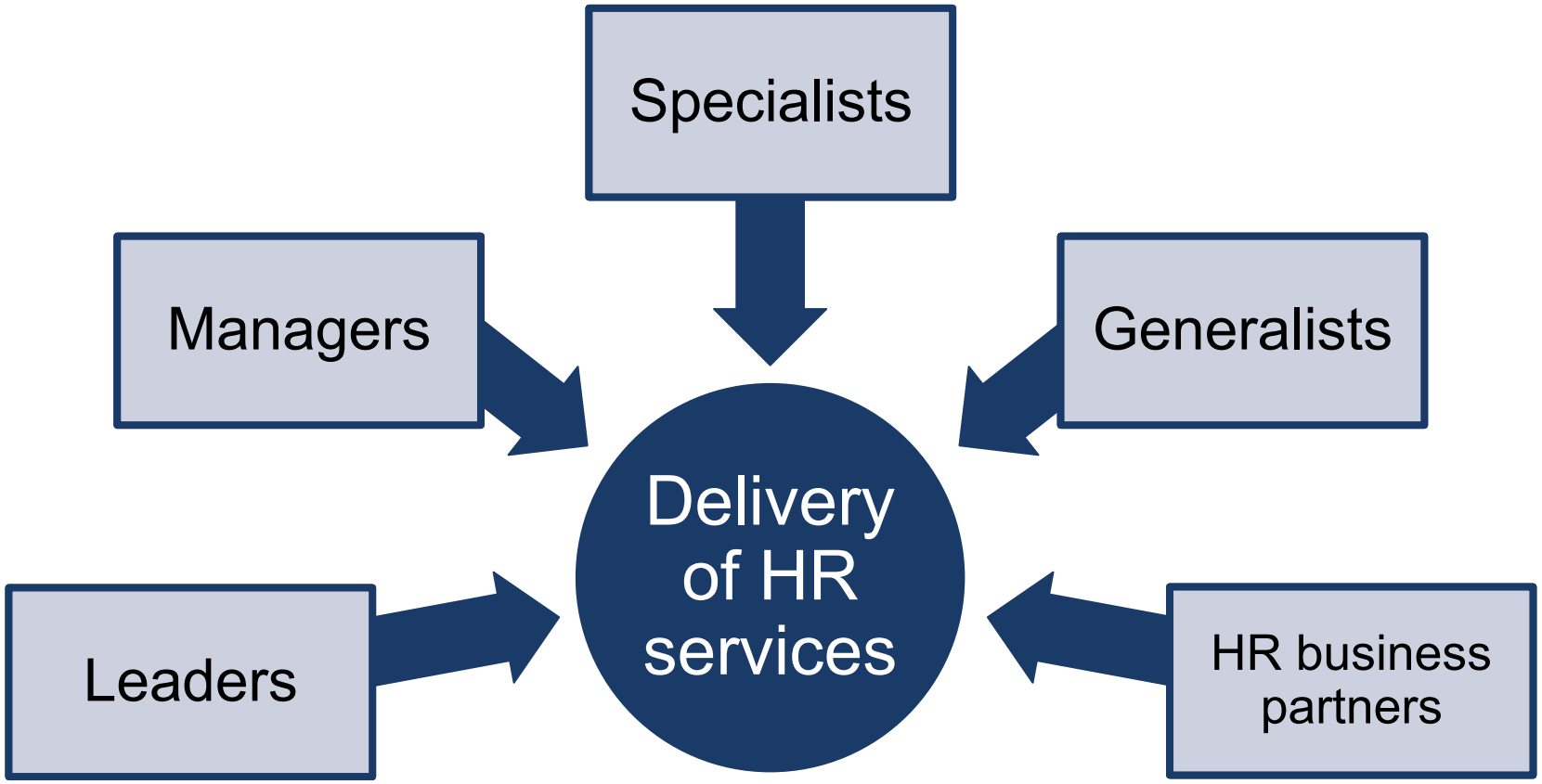
- Develops, produces, and distributes products/ services.
- Concerned with efficient use of resources, quality, environmental impact, worker health and safety.
- Requires complex logistics and sophisticated planning.

IT

- Manages storage, access, exchange, and analysis of organizational data through hardware and software systems.
- Supports integration of data across enterprise through ERPs.
- Maintains security and reliability of data.

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HR Team


Specialists
Managers
Generalists
Delivery of HR services
Leaders
HR business partners

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HR Structural Alternatives

Centralized

- All HR personnel are located within the HR department.
- Headquarters makes all HR policy and strategy decisions and coordinates all HR activities and programs.
- Helps ensures standardized HR policies and processes.
- Creates efficiencies in delivery of services.

Decentralized

- Each part of the organization controls its own HR issues.
- Strategy and policy may still be made at headquarters, but HR staff within each function, business unit, or location carries out the required activities.

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HR Structural Alternatives

Functional

- Headquarters HR specialists craft policies.
- HR generalists (e.g., located within divisions or other locales) implement these policies, adapt them as needed, and interact with employees.

Dedicated

- HR function at headquarters and separate HR functions located (or “embedded”) in separate business units.
- Corporate HR articulates basic HR values, develops tools to be used by the organizational-level HR functions, and creates programs (e.g., global literacy and leadership skills).
- Business unit HR staff develops local policies and practices.

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HR Structural Alternatives

Shared Services

- Centers with specific areas of expertise develop HR policies in those areas and then offer the service to all units.
- Frequently used in organizations with multiple business units.
- Units select what they need from a menu of shared services (usually transactional).

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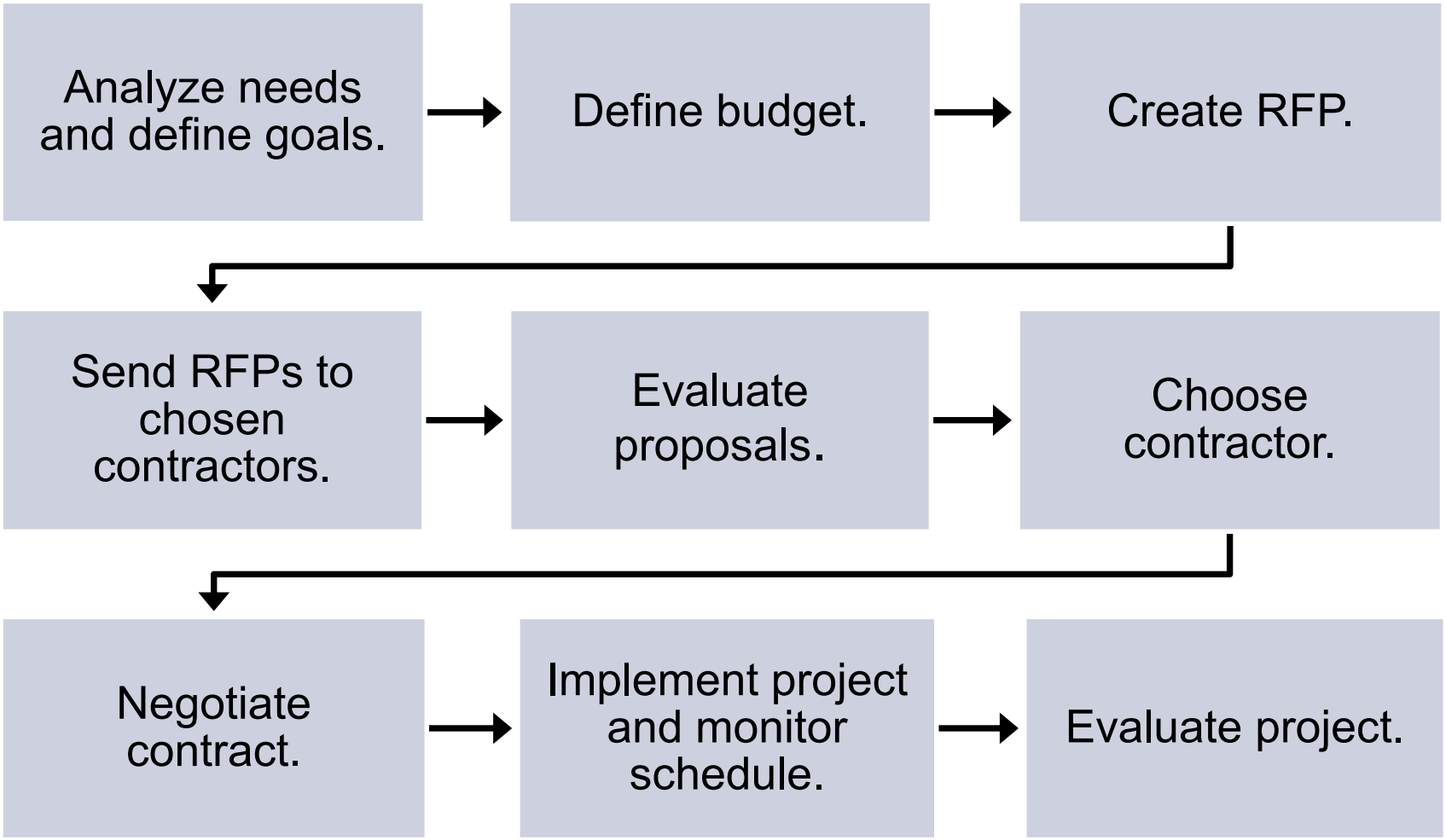
Third-Party Contractors

Successful outsourcing/cosourcing depends on:

- Choosing the right activities to outsource/cosource.
- Alignment of vendor's performance objectives with strategic requirements.
- Confirmation of vendor's reliability, capacity, expertise, and ethical behavior.

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Outsourcing Process



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Demonstrating HR's Value

Benefits of measuring and reporting results include:

- Reinforcing HR's role in strategic development by measuring the effectiveness of HR strategies and senior management's implementation of those strategies.
- Identifying opportunities for redirection and improvement through periodic measurement of progress on strategic objectives.
- Strengthening HR's relationship with internal business partners.
- Supporting future investment in HR programs.

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Evaluating HR Performance

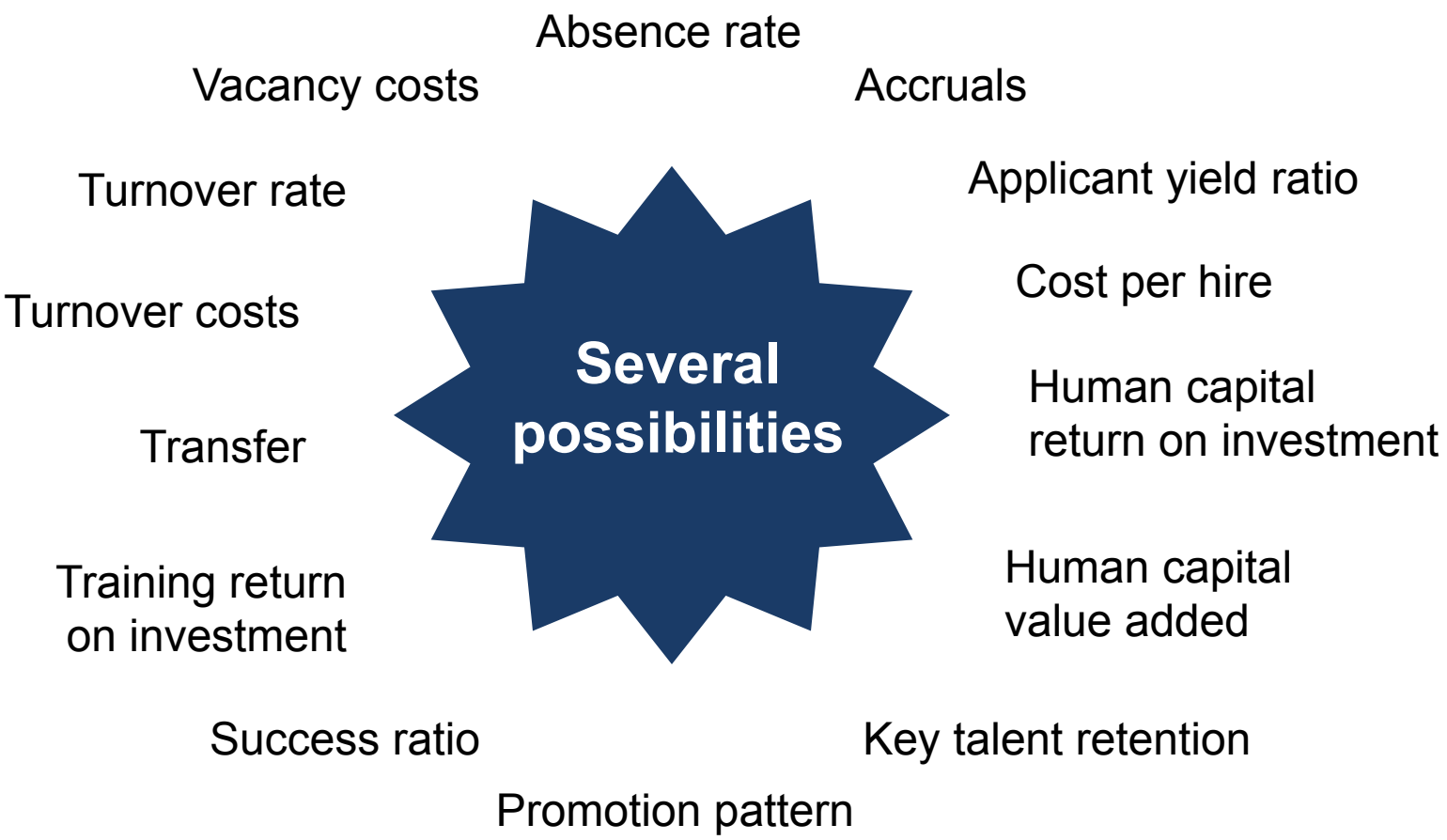
Balanced scorecards help support clear line of sight from strategic goals to strategic performance.

Effective balanced scorecards:

- ✓ Contain accountability and measurable results.
- ✓ Are valid (e.g., understandable measures, metrics, and targets that are aligned to an objective and supported by solid data).
- ✓ Contain only measures that are most important to the objective and the organization's strategic plan (e.g., measures must result in actionable items).
- ✓ Focus on results.
- ✓ Are carefully planned and executed.

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Sample HR Metrics



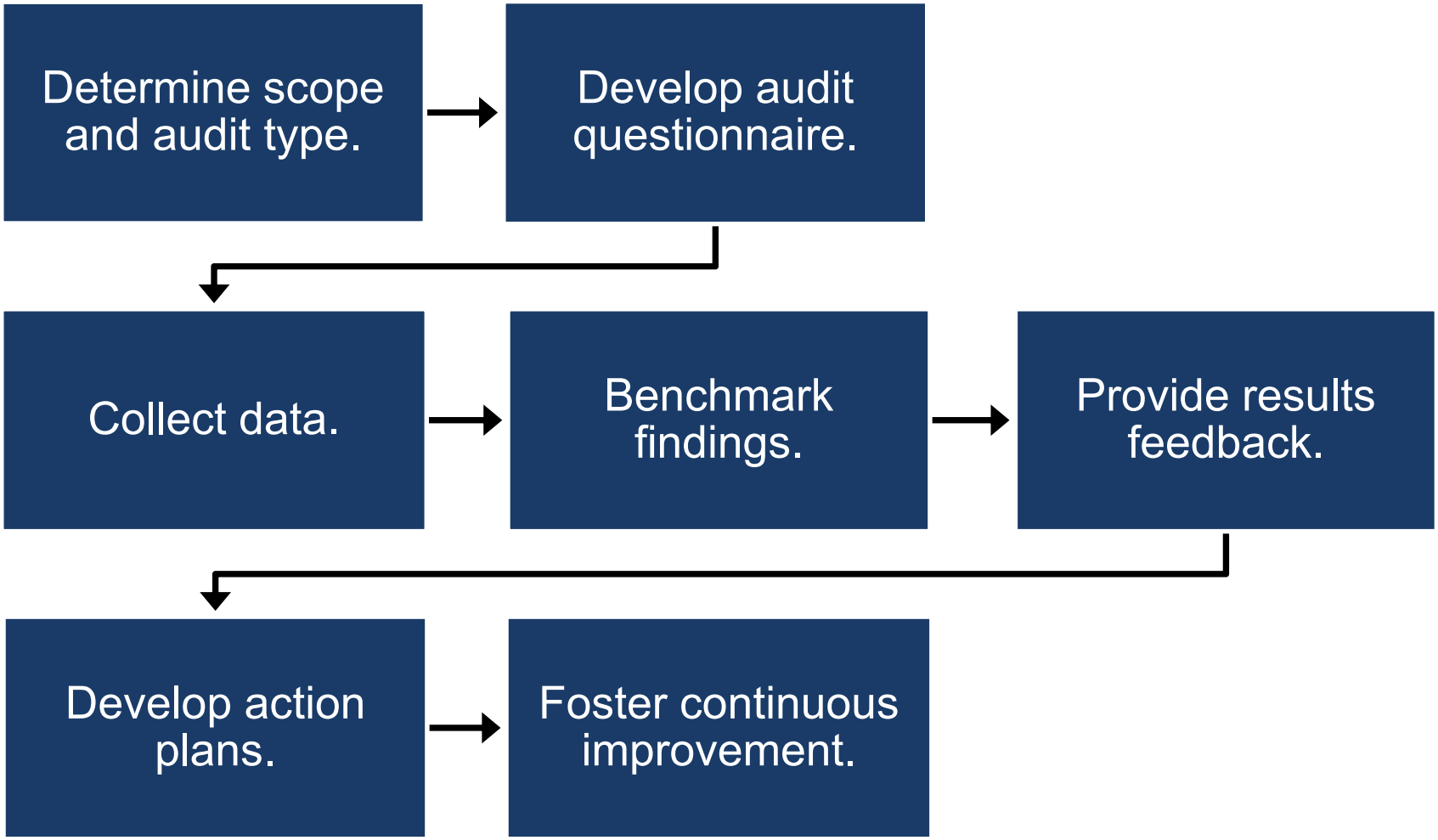
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Types of HR Audits

- Compliance
- Best practices
- Strategic
- Function-specific

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HR Audit Process



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Discussion

The newly appointed VP of HR is excited about participating in the upcoming strategy session and discussing a number of ideas on how to improve the efficiency of the HR department. These ideas will require a significant investment in technology and in upgrading the skill set of the HR department.

During the session, most of the other leaders provide direct and indirect feedback about the ineffectiveness of the HR department and complain that HR is out of touch with the rest of the organization. Often these leaders intentionally exclude the HR department and actively work around them until they are compelled to cooperate.

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Discussion

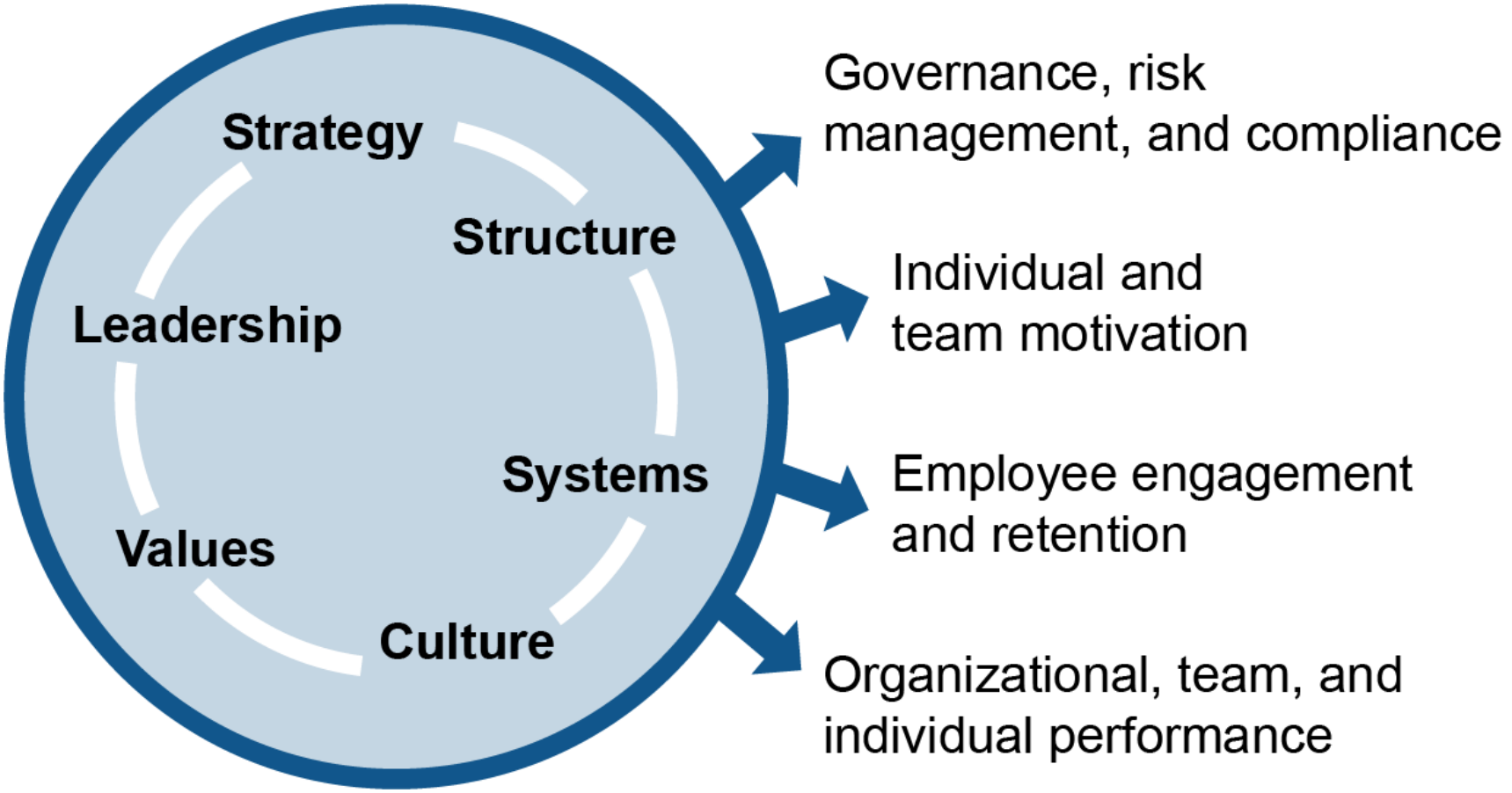
- What must the VP of HR do to convince the organization that the HR team is adding value to the organization?
- What competencies must the VP of HR demonstrate before other leaders support the implementation of the structural and operational changes within the HR department?

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Functional Area #7: Organizational Effectiveness and Development

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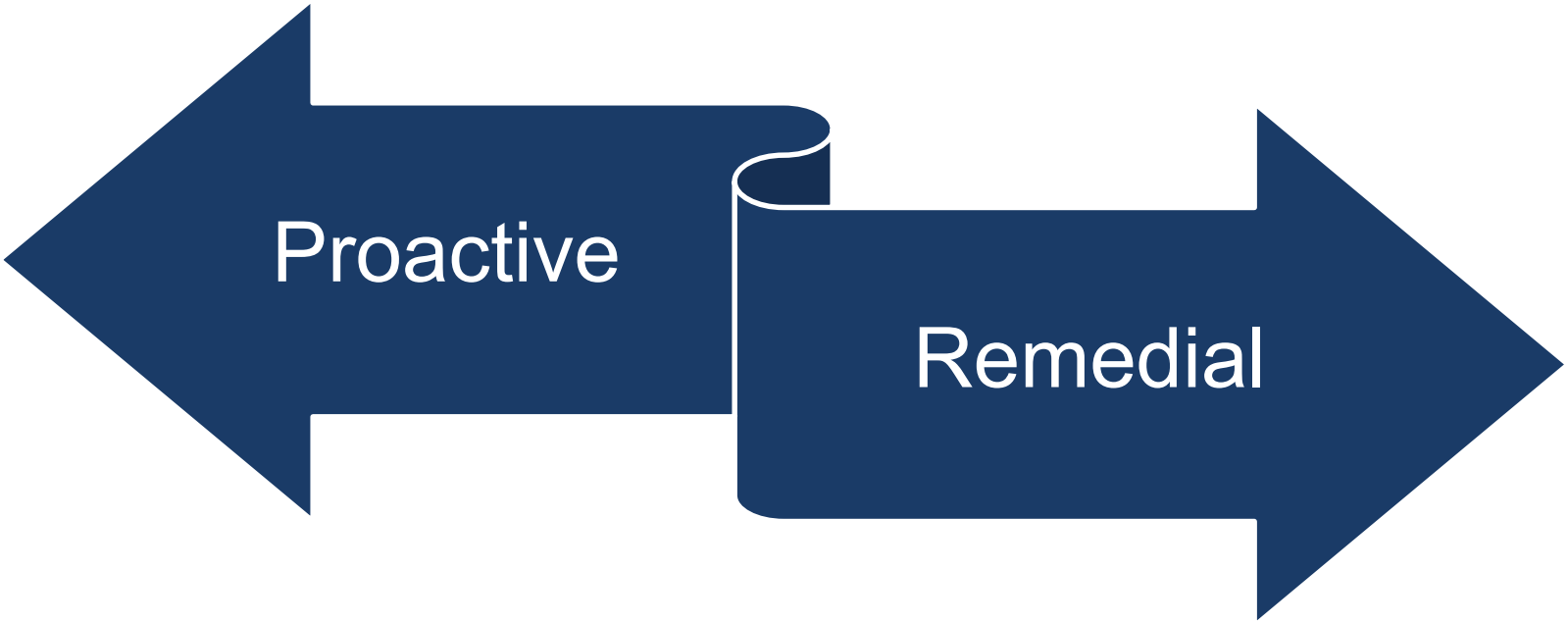
Organizational Model



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OED Interventions

Interventions can be seen as stepping in to interrupt the status quo in order to examine a situation more closely and make changes that improve outcomes.



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Characteristics of Effective Interventions

- ✓ Strategically aligned
- ✓ Collaborative
- ✓ Supported by top management
- ✓ Producing sustainable results
- ✓ Supporting continuous improvement
- ✓ Using common tools
- ✓ Using common language
- ✓ Explicit assumptions
- ✓ Fact-based
- ✓ Oriented toward systems and processes
- ✓ Flexibility
- ✓ Multiple perspectives

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Why Interventions Fail

- Lack of senior management support and buy-in
- Poor planning
- “Analysis paralysis”
- Reluctance to take reasonable risks
- Failure to communicate need
- Too much change for available resources, time, or change management capability

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Redesigning the Organization

Organizational design optimizes elements that support an organization's functioning, including:

- The organization's mission and vision and the strategies it is pursuing to achieve its goals.
- The way decisions are made.
- The way information is communicated.
- The processes used to perform work and the degree to which and how those processes connect parts of the organization's structure.
- The systems used to align the organization's needs with the resources required to fill those needs.

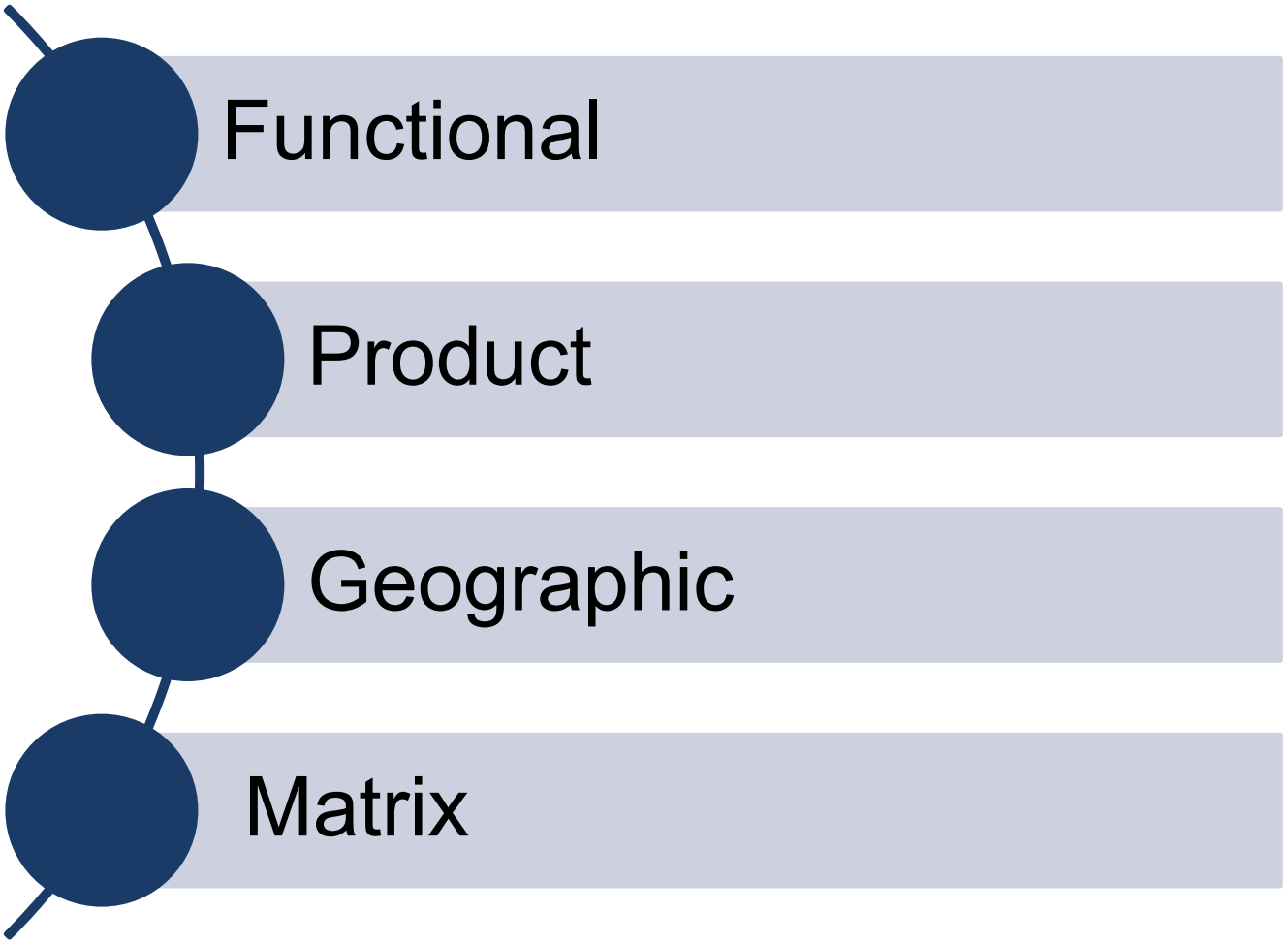
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Structural Characteristics in Organizational Design

- Work specialization
- Decision-making authority
- Layers of hierarchy
- Formalization
- Mechanistic and organic organizations

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Organizational Structures



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Assigning Roles in New Structures

- The RACI matrix describes roles as responsible (R), accountable (A), consult (C), and inform (I).
- RACI matrices help an organization establish clarity around critical activities by assigning responsibility and describing communication needs.

Activity	John	Mary	Team leaders	George
Documenting changes	Responsible	Accountable	Consulting	Informed

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Talent Development Interventions

Identify talent needs.	• Clarify performance standards. • Identify competency deficiencies.
Develop existing staff.	• Coordinate selection processes. • Develop comprehensive workforce development initiatives.
Build talent pool.	• Communicate performance expectations. • Develop coaching or mentoring programs and internal social networks.

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Organizational Culture Intervention



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Team or Unit Interventions

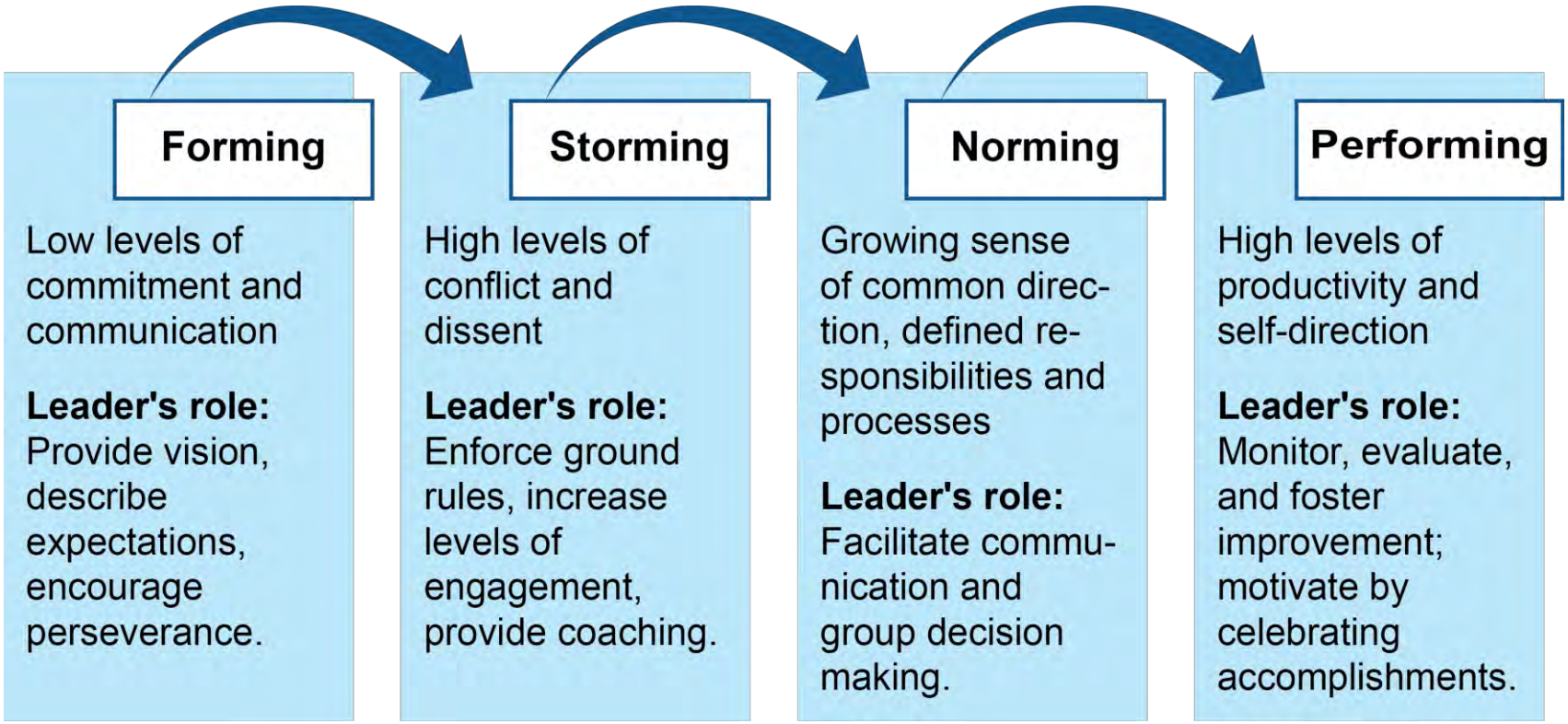
Goal may be to improve team processes and interactions through:

- ✓ Developing a team identity.
- ✓ Correcting dysfunctional behaviors.
- ✓ Redefining processes to remove conflicts and improve coordination.
- ✓ Building trust and helping diverse teams overcome cultural and geographic distances.

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Team Formation

Based on Bruce Tuckman



© SHRM

Group Dynamics

Group Roles

- Task roles
- Social roles
- Dysfunctional roles

Based on Kenneth Benne and Paul Sheats

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Team Building

Team-Building Activities

Activities may focus on:

- Goals and priorities.
- Roles and responsibilities.
- Processes.
- Interpersonal relationships.

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Discussion

A small, family-run organization has always pursued a differentiation strategy that emphasizes quality and customer service.

The CEO decides to retire and sell the business to a mid-sized competitor who has always employed a cost leadership strategy.

As part of the sale agreement, the CEO insists that all current employees be retained.

Within four months of the acquisition, the VP of HR sees that almost 40% of the acquired employees have left the organization, taking critical knowledge with them. If this continues, it will affect customer service.

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Discussion

- What type of OED intervention should the VP of HR consider first?
- What other activities should the VP of HR consider?
- What competencies can help the VP of HR to address this issue?

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Functional Area #8: Workforce Management

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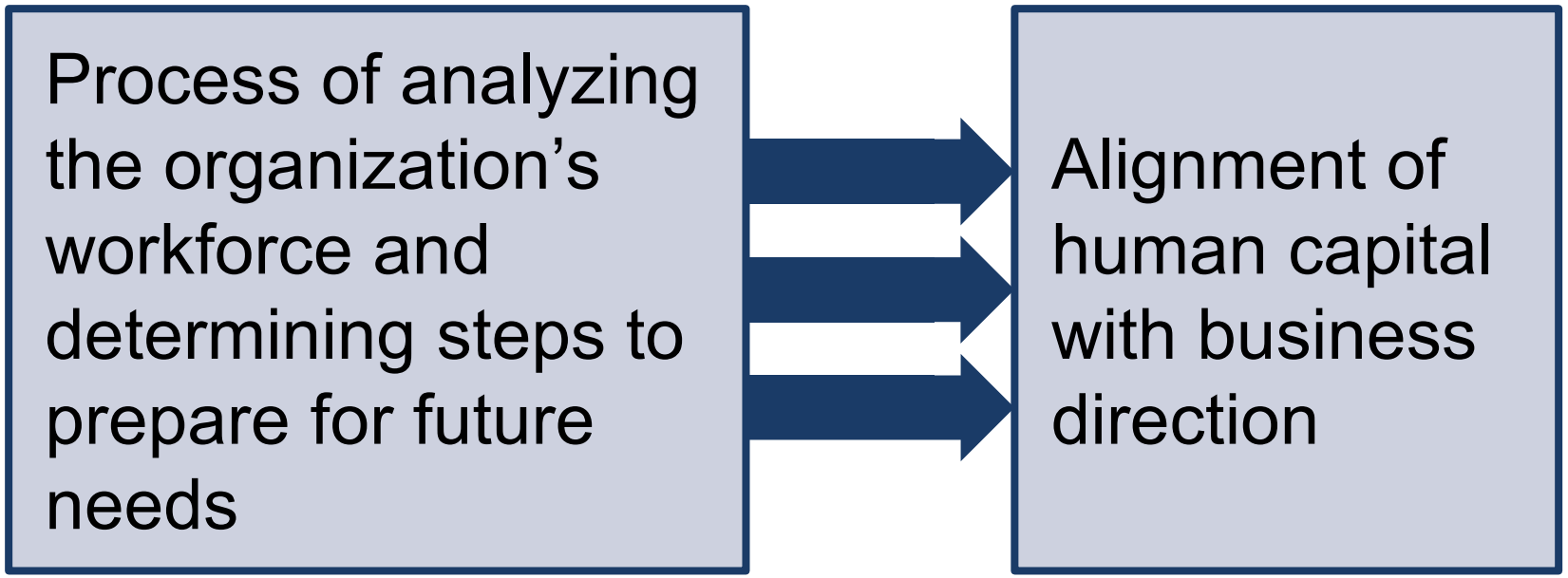
Workforce Management



HR manages human resources to maximize the organization's opportunities for success and minimize its exposure to threats.

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Workforce Planning



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Workforce Analysis Process

Supply analysis

Where are we now?
What do we have?

Demand analysis

Where do we want to be?
What do we need?

Gap analysis

What KSAs exist?
What is lacking and what will be needed?

Solution analysis

What can we afford?
How will we get what we need?

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Supply Analysis: Forecasting Tools

Accurate forecasts account for movement into and inside the organization (new hires, promotions, internal transfers) and out of the organization (resignations, retirements, involuntary terminations, discharges).

Turnover analysis

- Divide separations per year (or shorter time periods) by average monthly workforce.

Flow analysis

- Analyze career development plans.
- Obtain estimates of movement.
- Project future movement.

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Demand Analysis: Judgmental and Statistical Forecasts

Judgmental forecasts

- Assess the past and present to predict future needs
- Based on a variety of estimates

Statistical forecasts

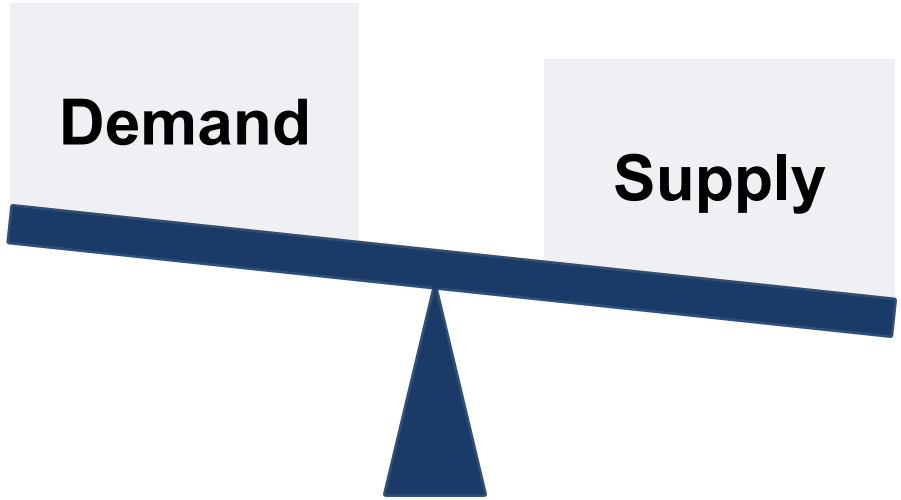
- Regression analysis (simple or multiple)
- Simulations (what if?)

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Gap Analysis

Compares supply and demand analyses to identify the staffing differences and competencies needed for the future.

- Skills
- Abilities
- Distribution
- Diversity
- Deployment
- Time
- Cost
- Knowledge sharing
- Succession
- Retention



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Prioritizing Gaps

- Permanence
- Impact
- Control
- Evidence
- Root cause

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Tactical Objectives

Focus on closing high-priority gaps in the near term (as opposed to the long-term HR strategic objectives); specify in concrete and measurable terms which gaps must be closed and when.

Tactical objectives support staffing needs because they:

- ✓ Specify which gaps will receive focused attention.
- ✓ Describe the degree to which the gap will be closed.
- ✓ Specify the time frame for achievement.
- ✓ Describe the localities or functional groups involved.
- ✓ Identify any special considerations.

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Solution Analysis

Build

- Redeploy
- Train and develop

Buy

- Recruit and hire

Borrow

- Outsource, lease, or contract

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Staffing Plan

Element	Description
Statement of purpose	Goals and targets
Stakeholders	Key decision makers and participants in planning
Activities and tasks	Necessary activities, tasks, and deliverables
Team members	Roles and responsibilities
Resources	Necessary financial and nonfinancial resources
Communication plan	Communicating, monitoring, gathering feedback
Continuous improvement	Evaluation and improvement strategy

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Flexible Staffing

- Uses alternative recruiting sources and workers who are not regular employees.
- Examples of where it might be used include:
  - Shortages of available workers for open positions.
  - Seasonal peak demands for operations.
  - Operational upturns and downturns that make permanent head count impractical.
  - Special projects that demand specific skills.

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Flexible Staffing Types

Administration by organization

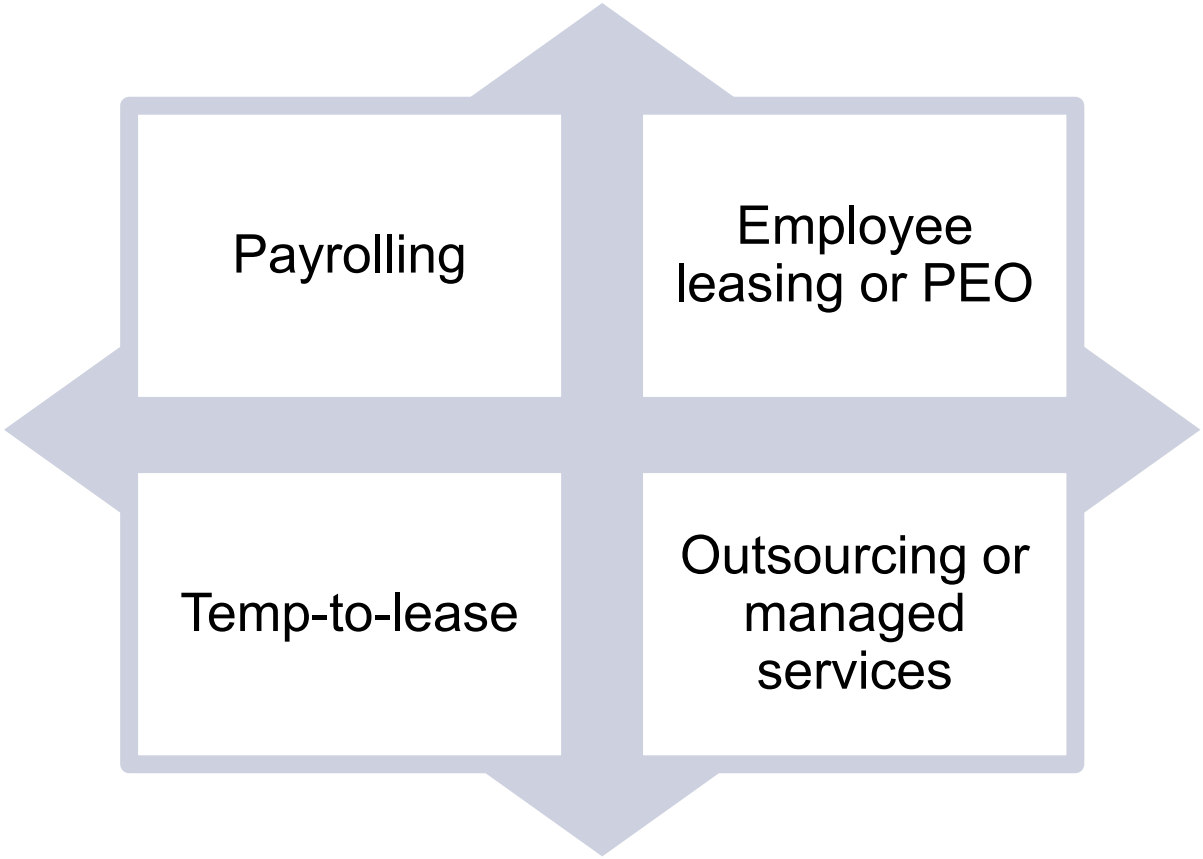
- Temporary assignments
- Temporary employees
- On-call workers
- Part-time employees
- Job sharing
- Seasonal workers
- Phased retirement

Administration outsourced

- Finite temporary help
- Temp-to-hire programs
- Contract workers

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Types of Flexible Staffing Arrangements



Co-employment (joint employment) agreements summarize legal relationship, rights, and obligations for some flexible staffing arrangements.

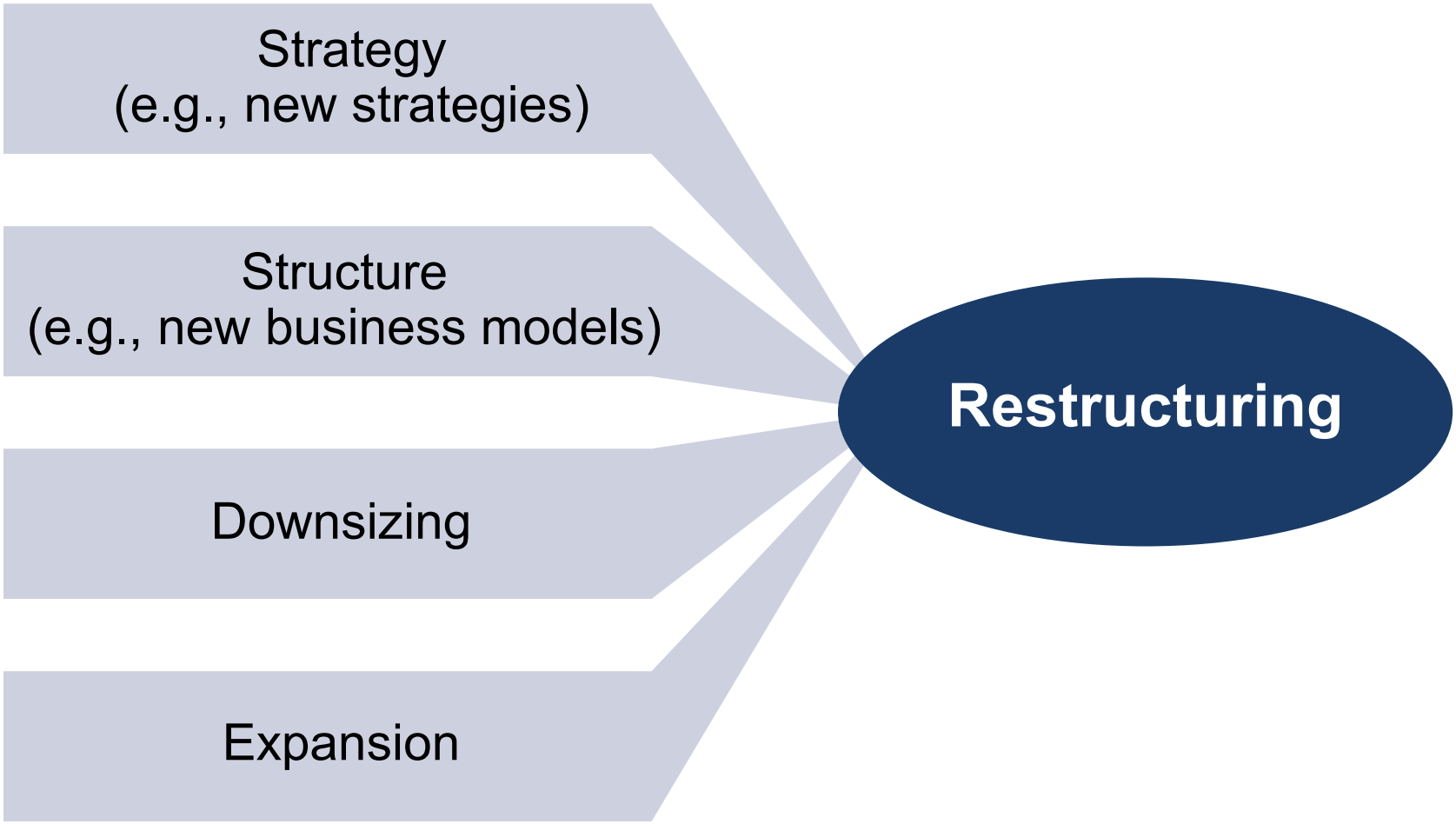
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Flexible Staffing Guidelines

- Be cautious of preprinted or standard forms.
- Ensure clarity.
- Negotiate competitive pricing.
- Consider including an ADR provision.
- Include a simple opt-out procedure.
- Negotiate clear and precise provisions for the expiration/end.

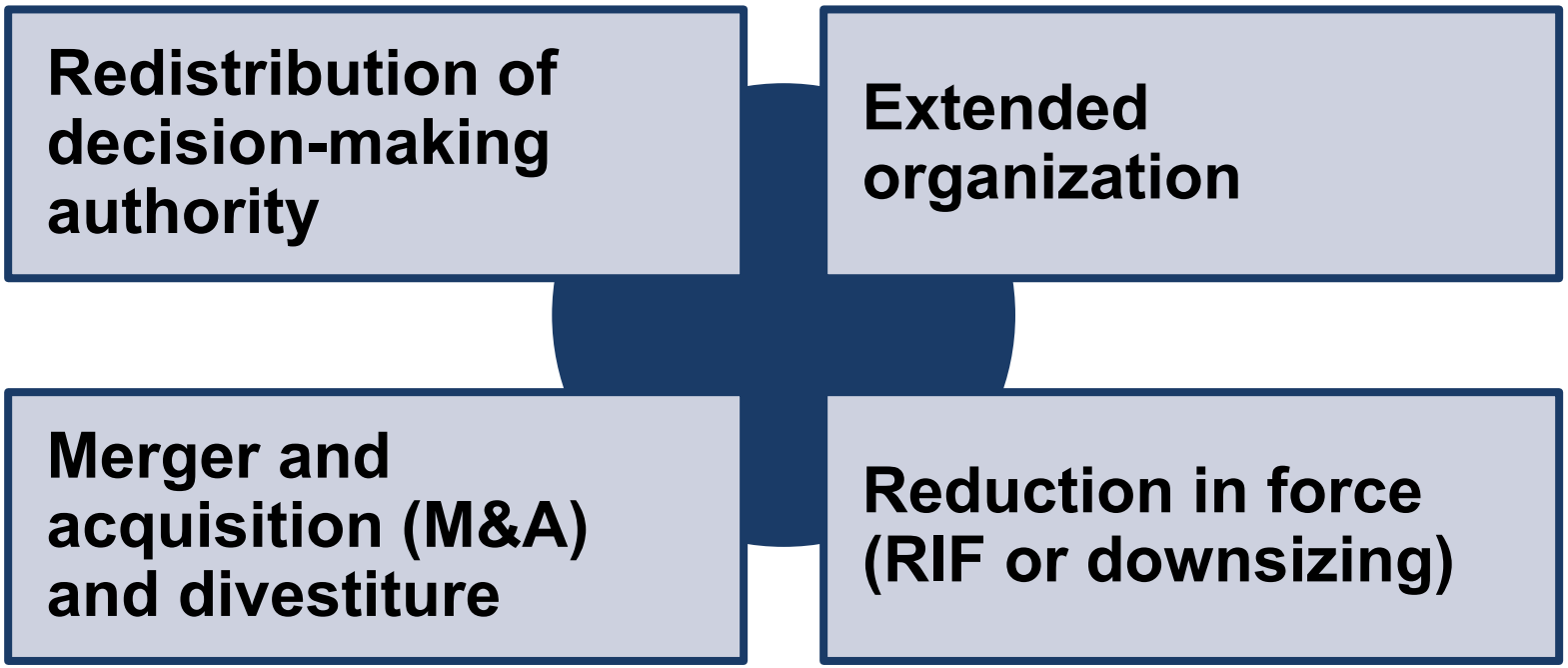
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Drivers of Restructuring



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Forms of Restructuring



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Talent Management

Attract, develop, engage, and retain employees with the KSAs needed now and in the future

Talent management decisions:

- Expectations regarding talent differentiation
- Philosophy of integration versus local differentiation
- Role of line leaders in developing talent
- Philosophy of talent mobility
- Diversity goals
- Beliefs about hiring for potential or position

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Talent Pools

Employees who meet a formal set of identification criteria (e.g., high-potential employees or potential global assignees)

- Represent an essential component of strategic business planning.
- Help target employee and career development efforts.
- Can be useful in international assignment planning and deployment.
- Represent a valuable resource during crisis management.
- Can help identify and recognize solid performers.
- May help in compensation decisions.
- Contribute to effective knowledge management.

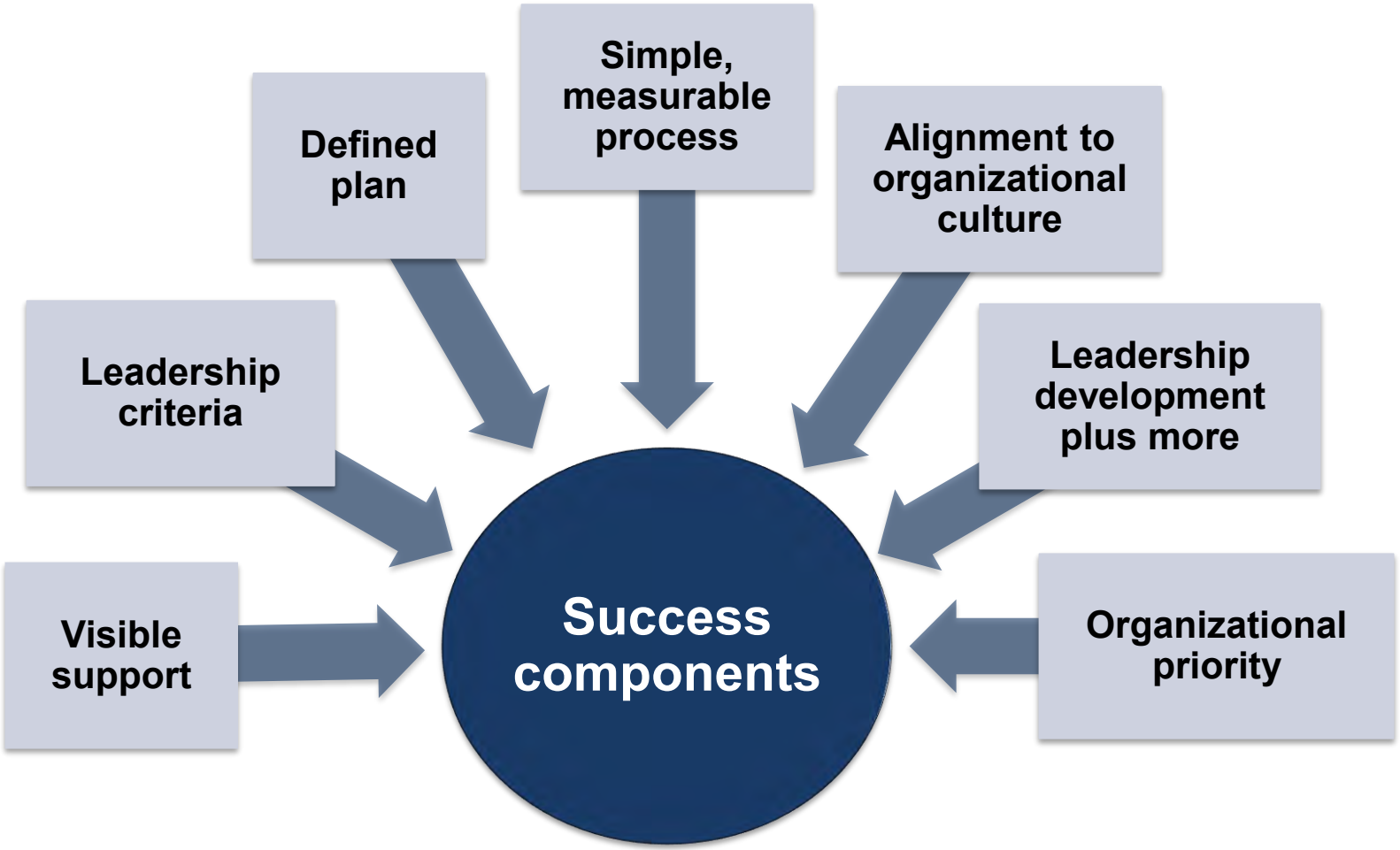
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Succession Planning

- Identify and develop high-potential employees for positions critical to future needs.
- Applies throughout the organization, not just to senior management.
- Must be aligned with career management, training and learning, and performance management.
- Focuses on long-range needs and cultivation of talent (unlike **replacement planning,** which focuses on immediate needs).

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Ingredients for Effective Succession Planning



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Evaluating Succession Planning

Approaches to measuring the effectiveness of the succession planning system

- Evaluate satisfaction with personal development initiatives.
- Assess management satisfaction with employee performance and job readiness.
- Measure time to full-function attainment.

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Knowledge Management (KM)

Process of creating, acquiring, sharing, and managing knowledge to augment individual and organizational performance

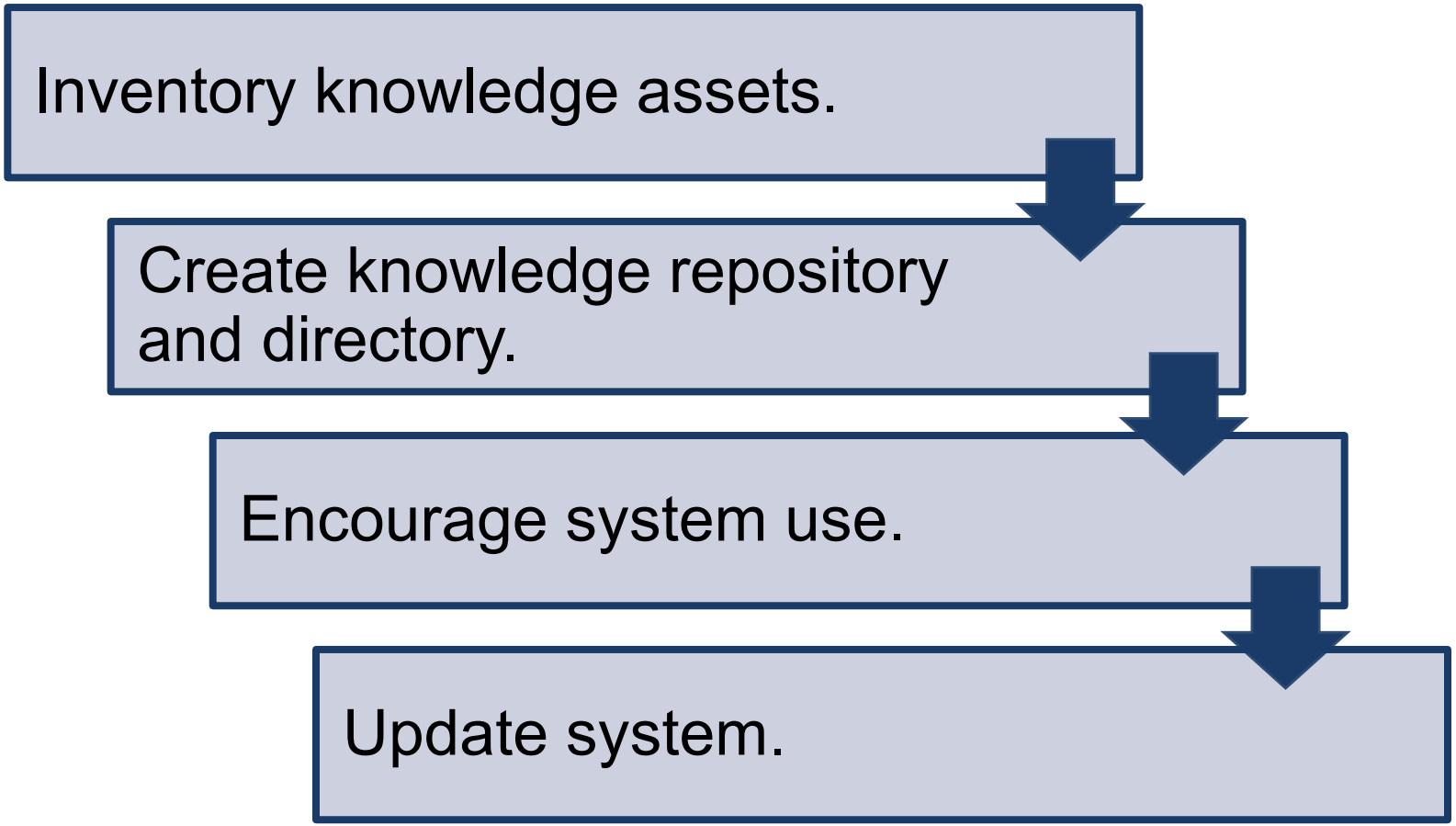
Institutional Knowledge

Expertise sharing and organizational learning	Knowledge retention and reduction of loss through employee attrition

KM systems may be informal or formal.

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Establishing a Formal Knowledge Management System



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Knowledge Management Success Factors

- ✓ Create and support an appropriate environment and structure.
- ✓ Assess where knowledge exists and may be lost or underutilized.
- ✓ Help people develop requisite skills.
- ✓ Address “What is in it for me?”
- ✓ Develop project criteria.
- ✓ Identify and address multicultural challenges.

Challenge is to transform ad hoc nature of social learning and knowledge transfer into more structured learning and knowledge management opportunities.

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Discussion

Due to business conditions, a CEO calls for an immediate RIF. All functions are directed to follow the CEO's plan for the RIF. The results?

- Meetings to inform selected workers are planned to occur with an HR manager and the site manager.
- However, rumors emerge, and names of selected employees become known.
- Site managers, inexperienced in RIFs, tell workers selected for reduction that they don't know why they were selected.
- During meetings, terminated workers are confused about how they could be fired (because they have always had good performance reviews and pay increases).

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Discussion

How could the company have more effectively prepared the employees for the RIF?

A. Post an announcement and send an e-mail to all employees about the business reasons for the RIF as soon as possible.

B. Answer employee questions as they come up after the RIF.

C. Conduct employee meetings and discuss the RIF and its causes as soon as the decision is made.

D. Do not communicate the bad news to the employees until necessary.

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Feedback

The correct answer is C. Employees should be informed face to face when this type of information is being communicated. Communication should be proactive and direct, include all employees, and come from leaders. This helps to mitigate rumors and would be a positive demonstration of the Communication competency.

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Discussion

Operations expresses serious concerns about the CEO's plans. How should HR respond to operations' concerns?

A. Tell operations to provide HR with the necessary documentation to follow the CEO's plan.
B. Meet with operations to make sure that they fully understand the CEO's plan to select RIF-affected workers.
C. Help operations create a list of critical workers, and then ask the CEO to exclude these people.
D. Listen carefully and sympathetically, but proceed as directed by the CEO.

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Feedback

The correct answer is C. HR is working to address operations' concerns as well as showing leadership in proactively offering sound reasoning to the CEO. Working collaboratively with operations is critical to this relationship, and advising the CEO of the joint decision and the reasoning will benefit all stakeholders. These actions demonstrate the Relationship Management competency.

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Functional Area #9: Employee and Labor Relations

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International Labor Standards

International labor standards reflect a consensus about employee rights and employer responsibilities. Even if they are not reflected in a nation's employment laws, they set a recognized bar that ethical employers strive to reach.

International Labour Organization (ILO) core standards relate to:

- Right of workers to organize and bargain collectively.
- Prohibition of forced labor.
- Regulation of child labor.
- Equal pay and benefits for men and women.
- Prohibition of discrimination and promotion of equal opportunity and treatment.

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Employer Rights Under the Law

- Direct employees' work and conduct of the organization in accordance with law.
- Protect assets from damage.
- Benefit from employee work through intellectual property.

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Employment Contracts

- Norm for employees in many countries; some countries mandate that employers provide contracts within a certain time after hiring.
- Can be implied by employment documents (e.g., pay stubs).
- Must be formally amended.

In the U.S., most employee relations not covered by employment contracts are considered “at will” (employment at-will, or EAW). Employees may be terminated by the employer with no cause, although employers must be careful not to violate antidiscrimination laws or various exemptions (e.g., public policy, implied contract, covenant of good faith and fair dealing).

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Employee Relationship (ER) Strategy

- Alignment with organizational strategy
- Alignment with employment laws and practices
- Vision describing the workplace culture
- Values underpinning the strategy
- Strategic goals
- Strategic initiatives



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Communicating the ER Strategy

Workplace policies

- Broad statements that reflect the employer's ER strategy.
- Provide a basis for HRM practices.

Employee handbooks

- Handbooks should reflect the organization's vision and values and be legally compliant.

Manager and supervisor involvement

- Must understand how ER strategy aligns with management practices.
- Should be able to fulfill the ER strategy in daily work.

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Labor Relations

Refers to the way organizations manage their relationships with employees as collective group rather than individually

- Frequently involves third parties (e.g., labor/trade unions, works councils, professional associations, government ministries)
- Requires direct HR involvement in developing and implementing labor strategy

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Labor or Trade Unions

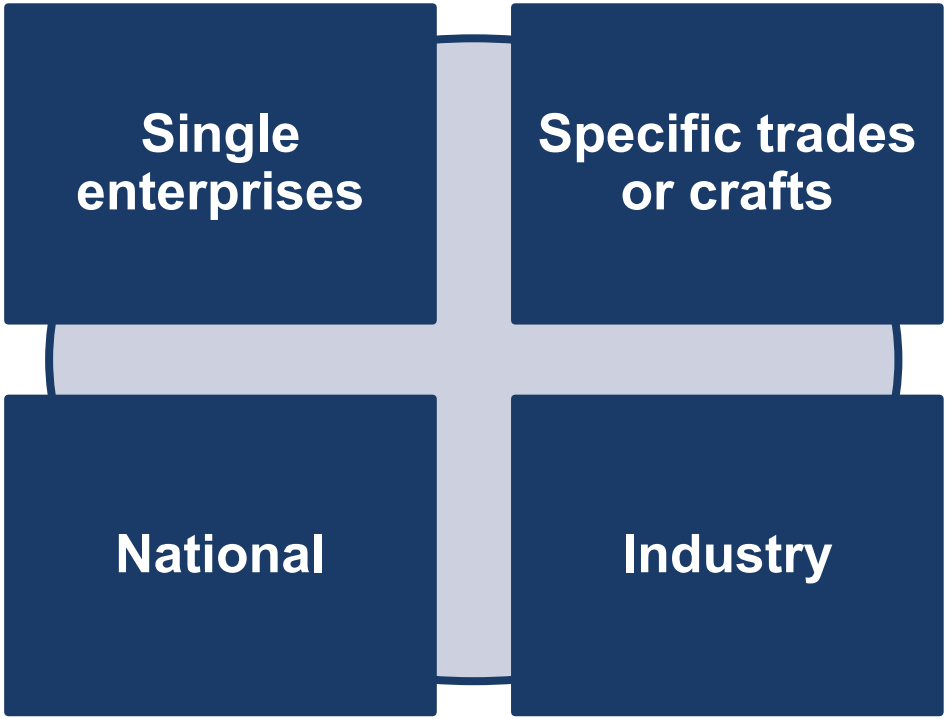
Group of workers who coordinate activities to achieve common goals in their relationship with an employer or group of employers

- Members elect representatives to interact with management.
- Membership may include managers and professionals as well as skilled/unskilled workers.

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Types of Unions

Large or global employers may interact with all types of unions.



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Know Your Union

- Level at which bargaining occurs
- Focus of bargaining topics
- Union penetration or density
- Membership
- Relationship with management
- Role government will play

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Labor Relations Strategies

Acceptance

Organizations accept unionization for various reasons.

Avoidance

Employers remove the appeal of unions by addressing the major reasons why employees join them.

Adaptation

When a workplace is already unionized, the employer defines the nature of the relationship as confrontational or collaborative.

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For Productive Union Relationships

- ✓ Comply with international standards and all employment laws.
- ✓ Comply with local regulations.
- ✓ Develop fair grievance and dispute resolution processes.
- ✓ Implement joint problem-solving groups.
- ✓ Treat union members equitably and respectfully.
- ✓ Demonstrate genuine appreciation for workers.
- ✓ Consult with union leaders proactively.

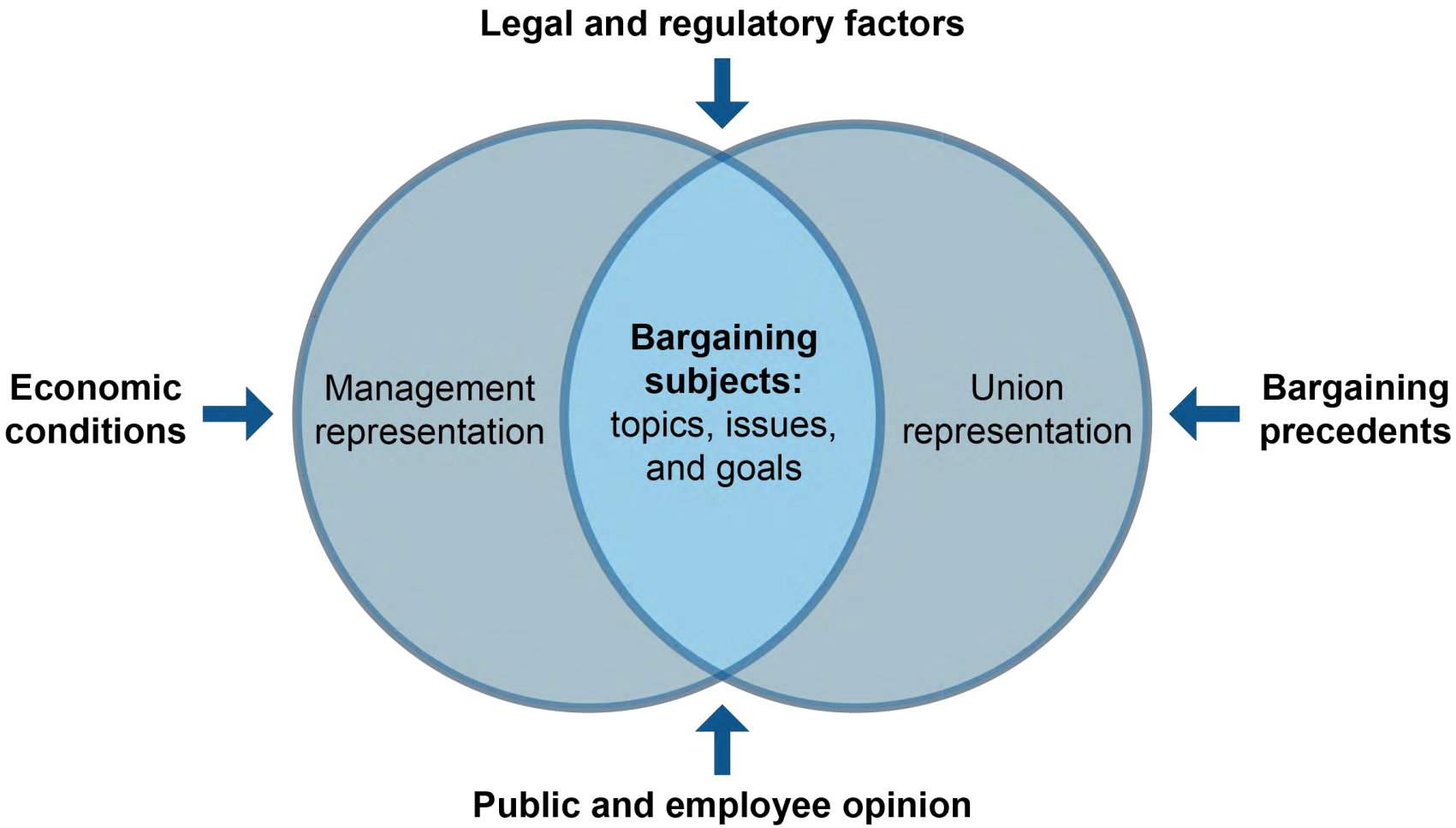
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Global ER Strategies

Hands-off	Locally managed.
Monitor	Headquarters expresses interest, but decisions are made locally.
Guide and advise	Headquarters offers advice and global policies, but decisions are made locally.
Plan strategically	Global policies and local practices are in alignment.
Set limits and approve exceptions	Some local adaptation allowed.
Integrate headquarters and field HR	Joint decision making.
Manage locally from headquarters	Headquarters-developed HR policies and practices with local implementation.

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Collective Bargaining



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Contract Negotiations

- Goal is to arrive at a workable contract acceptable to both sides.
- Outside third-party dispute mechanisms may be used (or may be mandatory) if parties cannot agree.
  - **Mediation (conciliation):** nonbinding dispute resolution intended to help disputing parties reach decision.
  - **Arbitration:** negotiated procedure in which both parties agree to abide by arbitrator's decision.

HR may not be directly involved in negotiations, but they can play a valuable role in improving the quality of the contract based on their experience and knowledge of metrics.

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Handling Grievances

Immediate supervisor	Next level	Higher-level management	Third-party determination
Grievance filed with supervisor. Supervisor and union representative investigate grievance.	Employee usually not present but is represented by union.	May involve top officials at local or company level. Must be resolved within contract-defined time frame.	Neutral third party used to arbitrate agreement between representatives at highest levels for both sides.

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Works Councils

- Permanent bodies composed of employee representatives on local or organizational level
- Receive information from employer that might affect workforce and enterprise
- Do not engage in contract negotiation

In the U.S., works councils are seen as violating Section 8(a)(2) of the National Labor Relations Act, which prohibits company-dominated unions.

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Works Councils Structures

- May include BOTH management and worker representatives or ONLY worker representatives.
- When worker representation only, may or may not involve management oversight.
- Codetermination:
  - Two-tiered corporate governance structure that allows both management and employees to participate in strategic decision making.
  - Topics include anything that affects workers, including HR policies and practices and compensation.

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Governments and Other Groups

Employer or industry associations

Negotiation partner when contracts are at industry or national level

National governments and agencies

Regulator, representative of social interests, sometimes part of negotiations

International groups

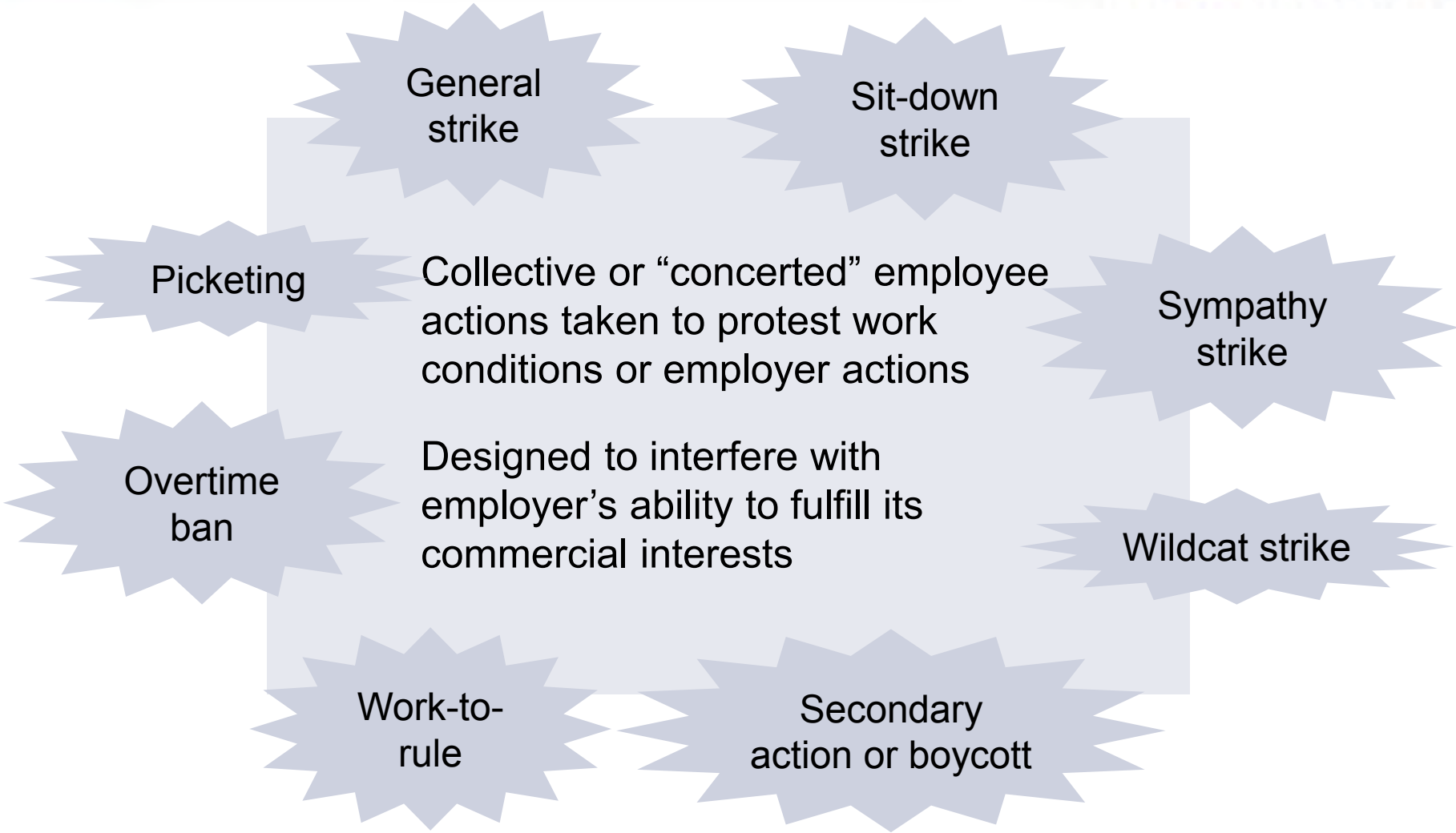
Advisory and expert role (e.g., ILO's Global Jobs Pact)

Local governments, nongovernmental organizations, religious institutions, community groups

Apply pressure on social issues, participate in task forces on employee relations issues

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Industrial Actions



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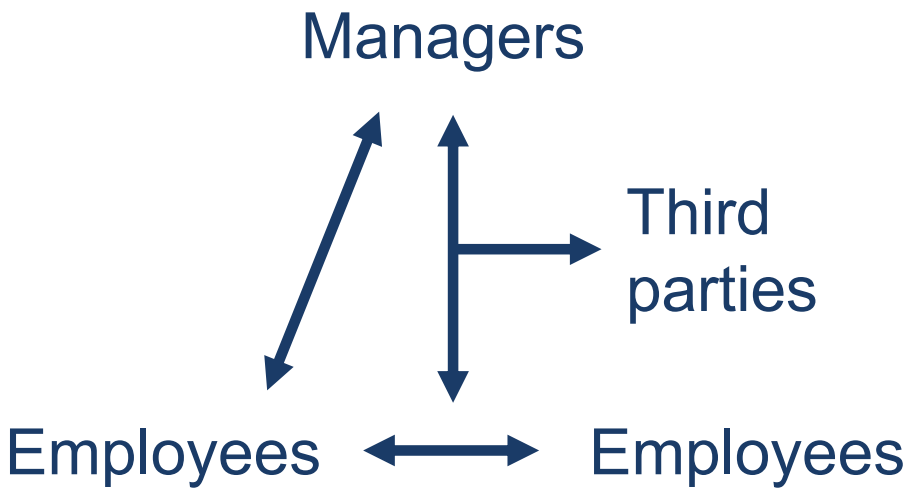
Unfair Labor Practices (ULPs)

Employer ULPs	Employee/Union ULPs
• Interfering with right to join union • Discriminating based on union membership • Refusing to bargain or provide needed information • Refusing to enforce contract • Controlling or intervening in union operations	• Conspiring with employers to discriminate against employees • Interfering with employees' freedom of speech • Not responding to member complaints • Refusing to bargain in good faith • Requiring unreasonable fees • Directing prohibited actions

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Workplace Conflict

HR may have to apply their competencies to manage different types of workplace conflicts.



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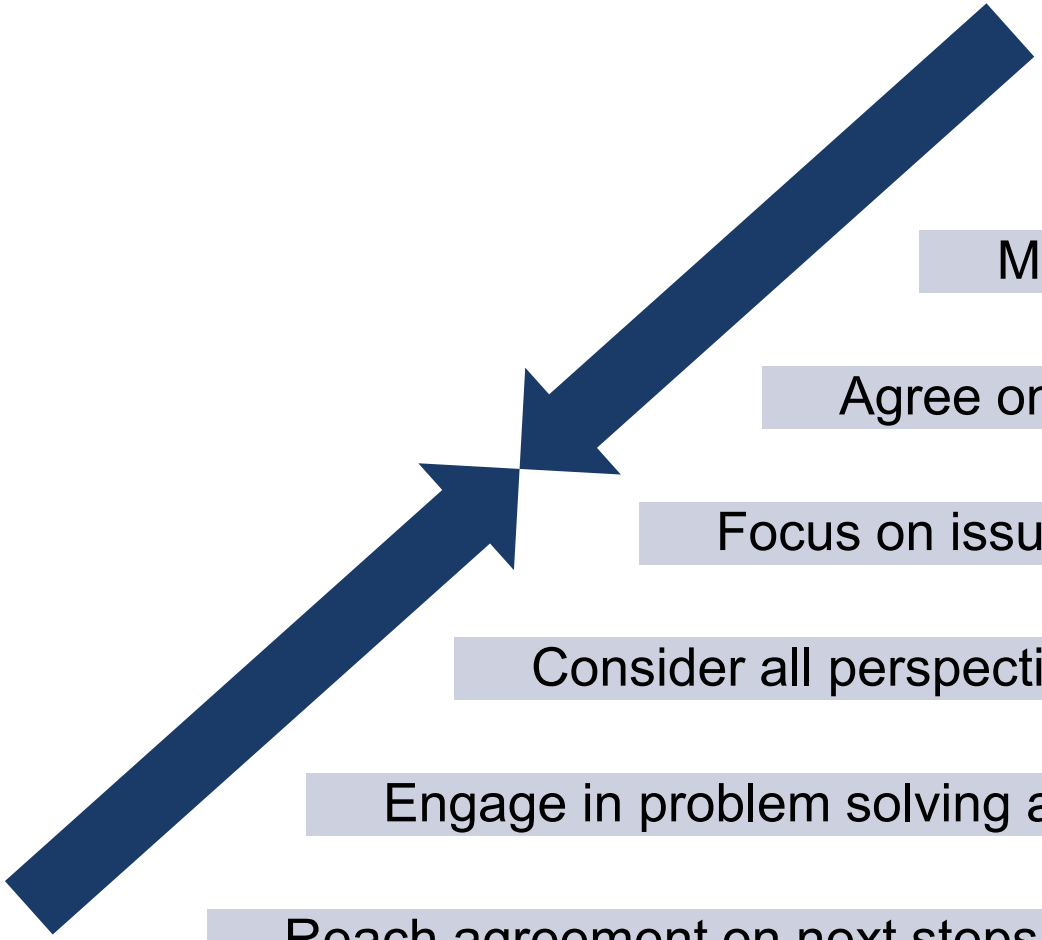
Multicultural Aspects of Conflicts

- Cultures differ in their appetites and tolerances for conflict.
- Cultural differences also affect the way in which the existence of conflict is acknowledged and then resolved.



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Dispute Resolution



Listen.

Manage own emotions.

Agree on goals.

Focus on issues and facts, not personalities.

Consider all perspectives.

Engage in problem solving and explore alternatives.

Reach agreement on next steps.

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Workplace Retaliation

Retaliation: Unlawful discrimination or other adverse action taken against an employee as a result of a conflict or complaint.

Employers should:

- Adopt and disseminate a strong antiretaliation policy.
- Inform employees about process for reporting retaliation.
- Train managers and supervisors.
- Monitor treatment of employees.
- Investigate allegations and take corrective action if necessary.

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Conducting Investigations

1. Ensure confidentiality.
2. Provide protection.
3. Select investigator.
4. Create plan.
5. Develop interview questions.
6. Conduct interviews.
7. Make a decision.
8. Close the investigation.
9. Develop written summary of investigation results.

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Third-Party Resolution Techniques

Legal and cultural norms, organizational requirements, and/or collective bargaining agreements can impact the choice and use of ADR.

Open door	Access anyone in chain of command.
Ombudsperson	Neutral third party investigates and mediates.
Single designated officer	Management appoints someone to investigate and resolve.
Chosen officer	Employee selects arbitrator from designated group.
Peer review	Panel of employees (and maybe managers) hears and resolves complaints.
Mediation	Neutral party helps both sides assess positions and reach agreement.
Arbitration	Sides tender dispute to a third-party judge and abide by the decision.

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Agency Complaints and Litigation

- Disputes that cannot be or are not resolved internally may be referred to government agencies or courts.
- HR professionals should be aware of:
  - Orientation of agencies and courts toward employers.
  - Specific role HR plays in complaints and litigation (e.g., active or passive—representing employer or providing evidence).

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Disciplining Employees

Good business practices include:

- Produce persuasive evidence of employee's culpability or negligence.
- Give employee fair opportunity to present his or her side of story.
- Determine penalty appropriate for given offense.
- Impose discipline that is consistent with treatment others have received for similar infractions.
- Incorporate HR review of all material/serious disciplinary actions.

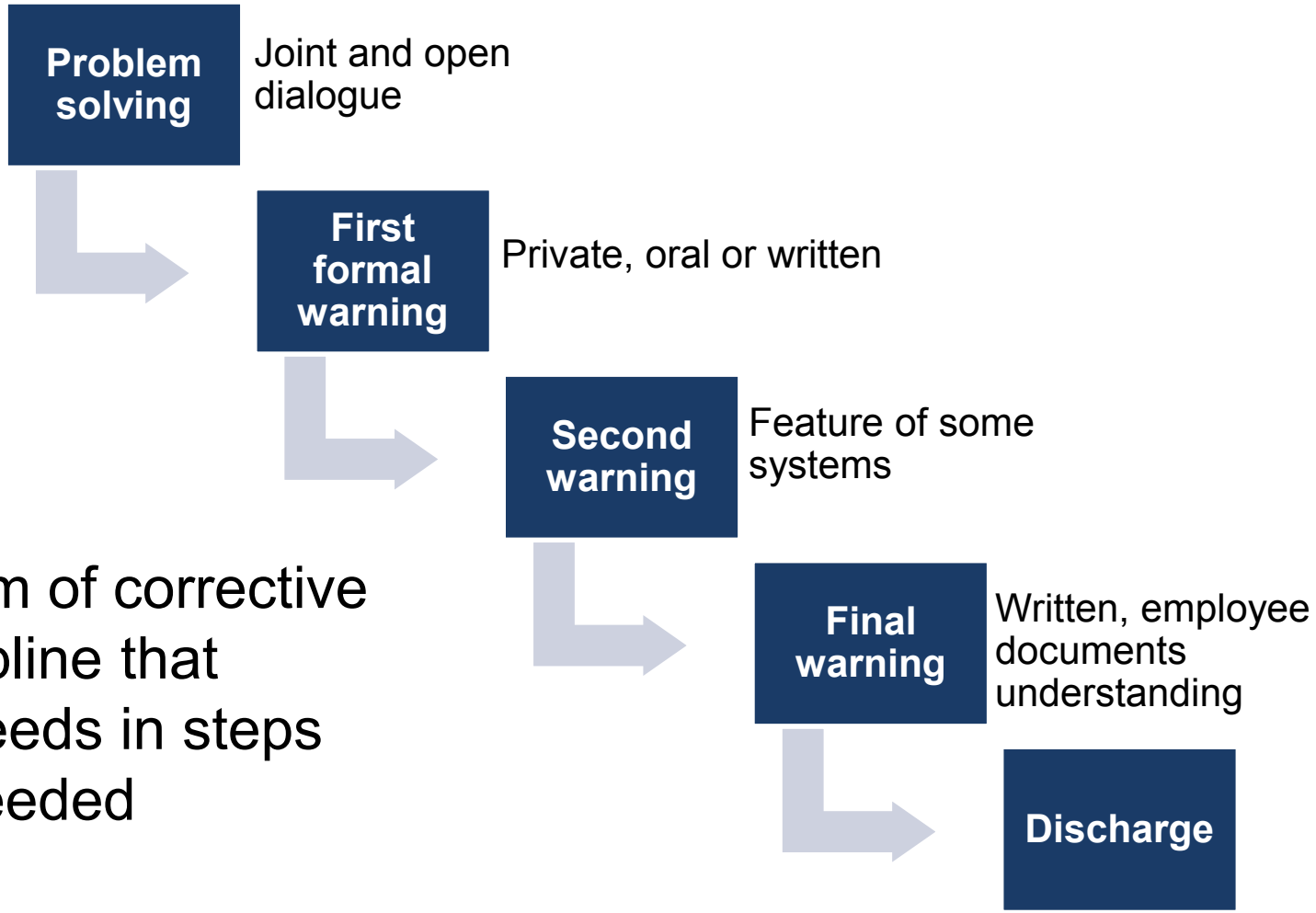
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Tests of Due Process

- ✓ Employee is informed of expectations.
- ✓ Employer is consistent and predictable in disciplinary actions.
- ✓ Action is based on facts.
- ✓ Employee is given the chance for defense.
- ✓ Employee has the right to appeal.
- ✓ Constructive discipline is used.
- ✓ Employee is considered as an individual.

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Constructive Discipline



A form of corrective discipline that proceeds in steps as needed

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Discussion

A family-owned industrial manufacturing company has a warehouse department of approximately 15 men. Most of their work involves driving forklifts to load and unload trucks. The warehouse workers rarely interact with other employees because of the way the facility is laid out.

A female employee bids into the warehouse and gets the job. She is immediately subjected to continuous harassment from coworkers, including dirty jokes and sexually explicit language. The males will usually help each other, but they will not help her.

The company has not done any harassment training for its employees. It has policies about harassment and physical contact but has been inconsistent in enforcement.

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Discussion

The female employee tolerates the behavior at first, but when things don't improve, she complains to the warehouse supervisor. He tells her that she needs a "thicker skin."

The supervisor tells the male employees the female has complained about them, but he does not discipline them. The verbal abuse and poor treatment continue until one day a male employee pinches her and, frustrated, she punches him.

Recently, a second female has bid for a warehouse position and is waiting to be moved into the job.

The HR manager has been discussing this situation with the CEO as it has developed, but the CEO responds by saying, "This is why we never hired women for this job."

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Discussion

- How would you manage the physical altercation, which violated company policy against physical contact?
- How would you respond to the behavior of the warehouse supervisor?
- How would you respond to the CEO?
- What Behavioral Competencies are needed here?

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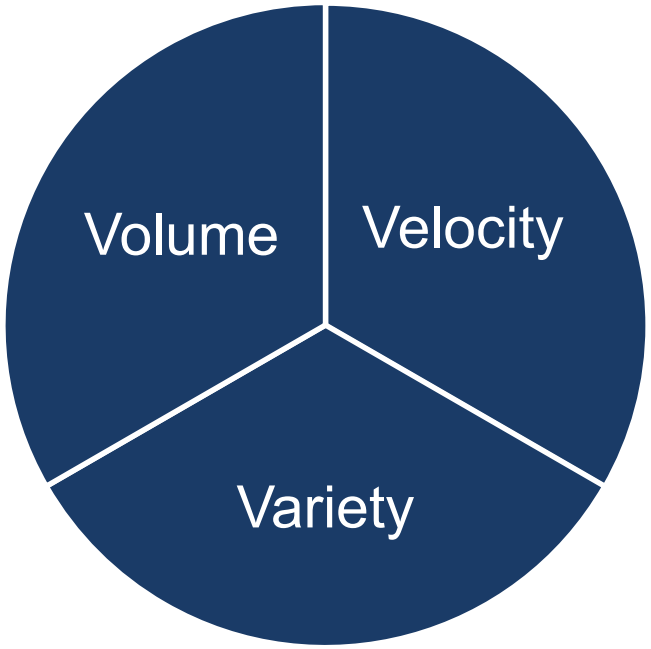
Functional Area #10: Technology Management

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"Big Data"

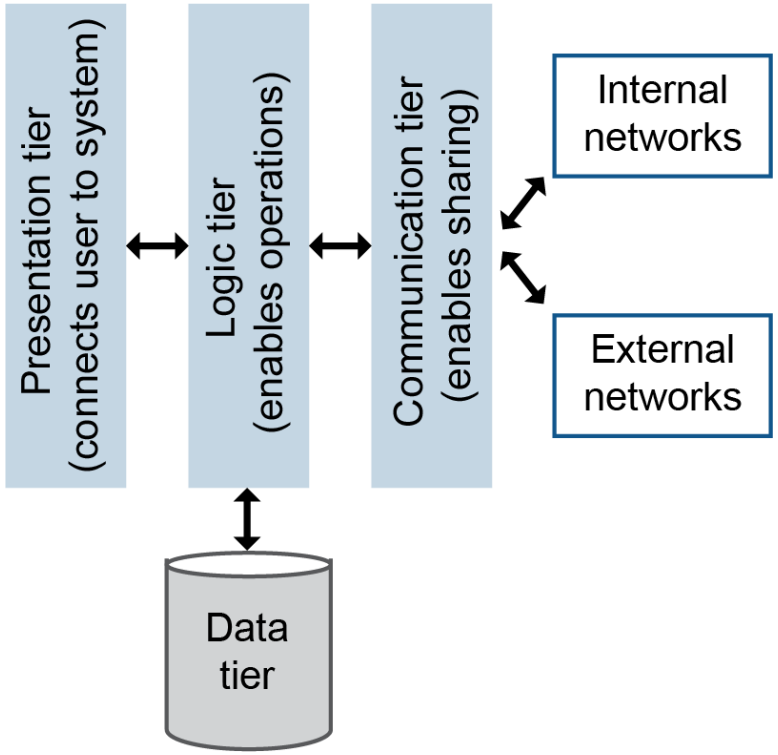
Three features of big data have changed technology requirements for organizations: volume, velocity, and variety.

Big data can help HR by collecting new data, using existing data more effectively, and allowing for better strategic analysis.



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Information System Components



- Information systems are a way to collect, organize, store, analyze, and share data.
- They feature four basic component tiers:
  - Presentation
  - Application
  - Data
  - Communications

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Integration

Enterprise resource planning (ERP) systems

- Designed to allow different parts of an organization to access the same data
- Designed for a generalized user's needs

HR information systems (HRIS)

- Specific technology that supports HR functions
- Component of an ERP system

"Best of breed" systems

- HR technology products designed to serve unique situations or satisfy specific preferences
- May not communicate with an organization's database successfully

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Scalability and the Cloud

Flexibility	Control
Economy	Security

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Addressing IS Security

- Ensure confidence in security of purchased systems and software.
- Assign appropriate user security levels.
- Implement governance policies and processes to ensure transparency.

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HR Technology Applications

HR software products can:

- Automate complex processes.
- Produce data for other applications.
- Support data analysis.
- Support compliance-related activities.

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Self-Service Technologies

Employee Self-Service Technologies

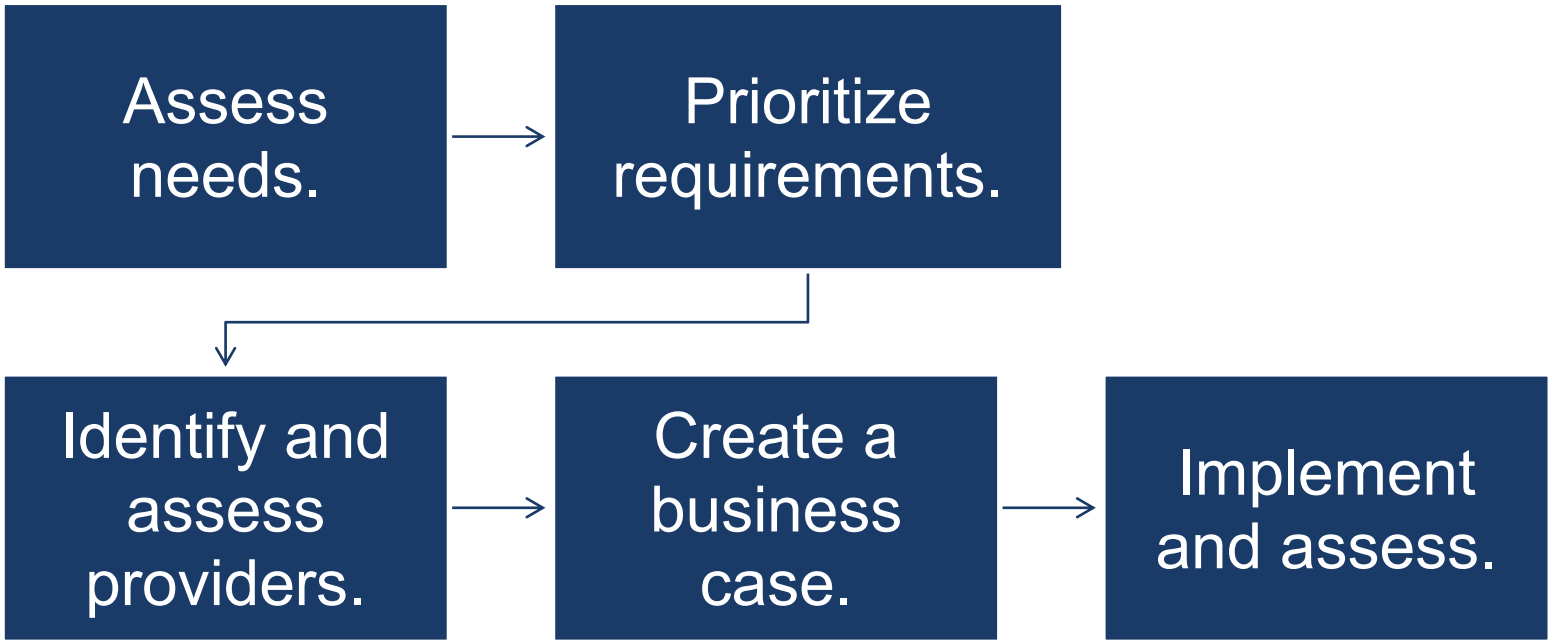
- Enable employees to enter and edit their own data

Manager Self-Service Technologies

- Enable managers to handle HR-related transactions
- Save time for everyone

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Purchasing Technology



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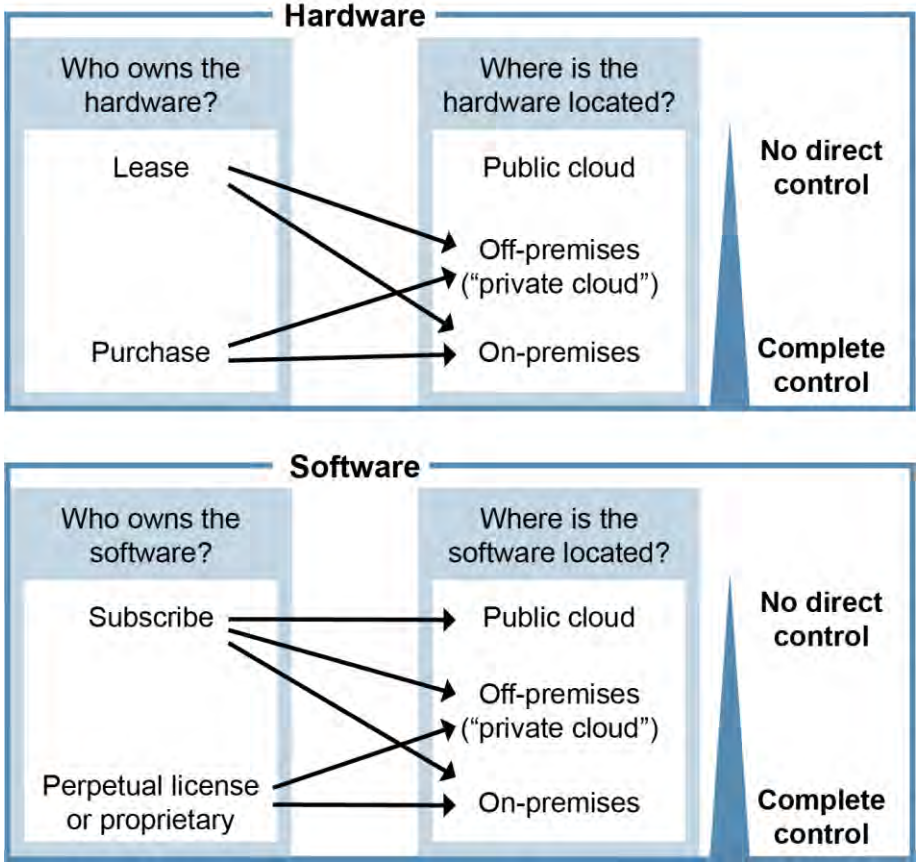
Conduct Internal Needs Assessment

After identifying all stakeholders, work to assess technology needs along three main fronts:

- HR's needs
- Users' needs
- Organization's needs

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Prioritize Requirements



What will meet our needs?

- On premises or in the cloud?
- Owned, leased/ licensed, subscription?
- ERP solution or BoB HRIS system?

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Research Providers

- Search and review online articles and vendor websites.
- Review analyst reports.
- Ask for recommendations from industry colleagues.
- Contact existing vendors.
- Attend HR professional meetings and technology trade shows.

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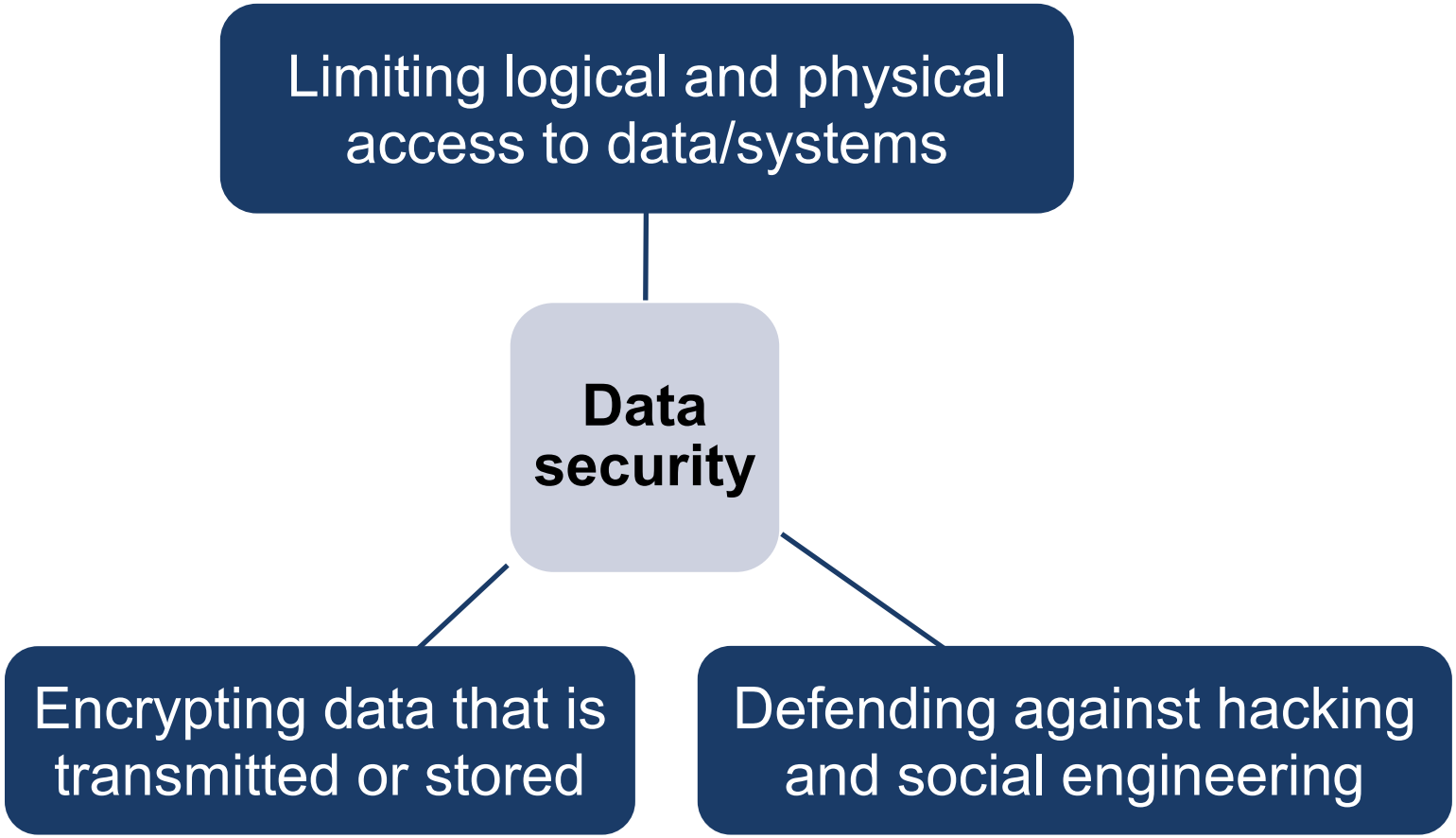
Create Business Case

Any major IT purchase will have to:

- Align strategically with organizational and HR objectives.
- Add valuable capabilities.
- Affect organizational risk level in an acceptable manner.
- Provide a reasonable return on investment.

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Data and System Security

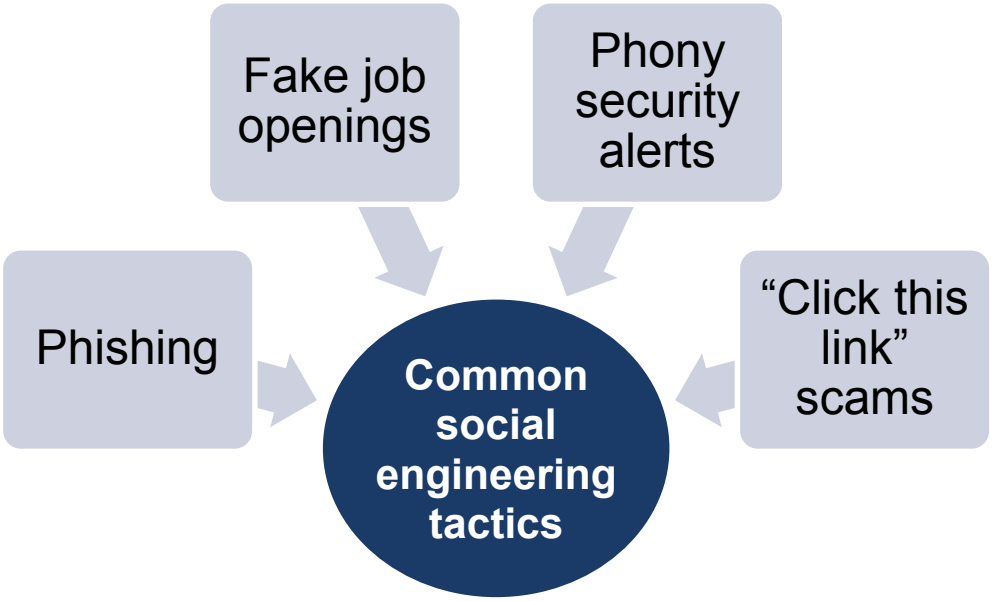


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Social Engineering

Train users to:

- Never disclose a password to anyone.
- Not give private information to anyone they do not know.
- Click links only from trusted sources.
- Delete unsolicited e-mails.
- Assess requests and investigate if they are unusual.



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GDPR Themes

- Transparency
- Individual rights of access to/ control over data
- Legality of processing
- Data quality and minimization
- Data sharing
- Data transfers
- Data breaches
- Accountability

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Collaboration Policies and Approaches

Organizations have introduced communication practices designed to maintain structure while, as much as reasonably possible, allowing for natural aspects of human interaction.

Examples:

- Meeting times that can accommodate most participants
- Creating agendas with time estimates for each topic
- Providing the meeting host full control over technological tools
- Recording discussions/meetings
- Using passcodes to restrict participation to invitees
- Hierarchies of authority for access to documents
- Legal disclaimers outlining rights/responsibilities
- Balancing security and rights protection with accessibility

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"Bring Your Own Device" (BYOD)

Realistic BYOD policies allow employees to use their personal digital devices to access the organization's network but define certain restrictions on their use.

- Restrict the use of personal devices while the employee is working in the workplace.
- State which devices will be supported by IT and the requirements for using the device.
- Clarify financial arrangements and legal rights.
- Define security measures.

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Developing Social Network Policies



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Social Media Policy Inclusions

- Prohibitions on use of organization's resources
- Prohibitions on disclosing confidential information
- Situations requiring employer approval for postings
- Rules about personal endorsement of organizational products/services
- Rules for posts about colleagues
- Statement that employees will be held accountable for any violations of laws or policies

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Discussion

A retail operation has stores in five locations and a corporate office in which one HR director handles all HR functions. The organization has about 150 employees; 20% are full-time and the remaining 80% are part-time. The organization has approximately 40% turnover annually at their retail stores. The owners are planning to increase the number of stores to ten within the next five years.

Currently, the only automated HR function is payroll. The rest are managed through paper or spreadsheet. Because of a previous incident within the organization, management is very concerned about the limits of data security with electronic systems.

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Discussion

The HR director is concerned about being able to maintain accurate records while adding the number of employees but also wants to reduce the amount of time spent on administrative functions and focus more on talent management, retention, and employee engagement. There is no performance management program or compensation structure in place. Currently, the HR director spends 30% of available time updating the payroll system, spreadsheets, and other related information to add and delete employees.

At a recent SHRM chapter meeting, a technology vendor conducted a demo of an HRIS. The human resource director believes a product like this would reduce the time spent on administrative functions and increase time spent on strategic activities.

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Discussion

What is the first step the HR director should take to invest in an HRIS for the organization?

A. Contact the vendor that presented at the SHRM chapter meeting and request a quote.
B. Involve appropriate stakeholders to analyze an investment in an HRIS.
C. Talk with several HR professionals to obtain feedback on the systems they use in their organizations.
D. Create a business case to identify the reasons to implement an HRIS.

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Feedback

B is the correct answer. A business case will most likely be needed (**D**), but the case will be stronger with more perspectives and allies. As a first step, involving other stakeholders will improve the quality of the business case.

A is incorrect because an analysis of benefits and costs to the organization should be completed first.

C yields information that may be useful in preparing a request for proposal, but it is not a first step.

This question calls for using the Business Acumen competency.

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Discussion

What would be the best way to handle management's concern about data security in an HRIS?

A. Collaborate with internal IT professionals trusted by management to develop a security strategy.
B. Request a contract from the HRIS vendor that assures that the system is secure.
C. Arrange for a meeting between management and the HRIS vendor's security professionals to reassure management that the data is protected.
D. Convince management to implement the system so they can have firsthand evidence of the security of the system.

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Feedback

A is the correct answer. Involving trusted IT professionals shows the HR director's awareness of this management issue and uses collaboration to address the concerns. This demonstrates use of the Consultation competency.

B is incorrect. A contractual promise does not equate with the ability to perform, and management is likely to know that.

C is plausible because it brings in expert advice, but management will probably trust internal IT experts more than external experts.

D is incorrect. Even if HR is successful in persuading management to go ahead with analysis, any security breach will hurt the organization's and HR's credibility.

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